

Iran War Risk

Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (P cut at 1mo/3mo, 24/31/41/56/77 → 20/28/41/56/77, committed and stamped by Alex, last COMMITTED baseline). The Aug 16-22 gap saw four abandoned drafts: Aug 17 (held flat), Aug 18 (cut to 17/25/38/54/76), Aug 20 (cut to 16/24/38/54/76, left for manual review over a UAE missile claim), and Aug 21 (a session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers — 2 of 6 reports touched, no render/selfcheck/archive/commit — before stopping). None were rendered, archived, or committed. An Aug 22 morning catch-up cycle (score set **2026-08-22_draft**) independently re-verified the gap via four parallel primary-source research passes, then adversarially fact-checked the load-bearing new claims before delivery — a step that caught a real error (see below) — and cut P to 14/22/38/54/76, delivered as a draft flagged for manual review. **Correction #1 (confirmed accurate):** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only, Iran denies and calls it a possible "false flag") and was NOT the first direct attack on the UAE as prior drafts framed it — UAE was hit by a missile/drone barrage Apr 1-8 and again at its Fujairah port May 4, both Iran-attributed by UAE's own government and predating Aug 18; that "novel escalation vector" framing is retired. **Correction #2 (a genuine miss, caught on adversarial re-check):** that draft initially described a fatal strike on the bulker Minoan Dignity (chief engineer killed, Aug 17-18) as "the first confirmed fatality" in the Hormuz tanker campaign — that is FALSE; it is one of a cumulative toll of seafarer deaths since the campaign began late February 2026 this report never previously surfaced or scored on. The Iranian vessel seizure (tanker Amara, held near Qeshm Island since Aug 17, first since June 22) IS confirmed accurate. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) is a separate, later-in-the-day FULL WEEKLY refresh** — the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 8 — that independently re-researched the pillar and ran a second, dedicated adversarial-verification pass specifically re-checking (a) whether the casualty-toll figure holds up and (b) whether anything was missed Aug 19-22. It holds up, but softer than a clean number: cross-checking Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (18 total), a mid-July gCaptain snapshot ("at least 15"), and IMO's own incident tracker (19 seafarer deaths, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly) puts the honest range at **15-19 cumulative deaths (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**, not a flat "18th death" — that softened framing is carried everywhere below. A UAE missile-attack claim the adversarial pass initially flagged as a possible miss turned out, on reconciliation, to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline, not a second incident. No new kinetic incident was found Aug 19-22. **P HELD FLAT this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as draft at delivery (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from auto-stamp), then reviewed and COMMITTED BY ALEX on August 23** after independent re-verification of the math and the research trail; see My Decision below. A daily catch-up draft dated August 28, 2026 (score set **2026-08-28_draft**) re-checked two more Hormuz tanker incidents and a single-source Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, holding P flat — but that draft was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, and is treated as abandoned/superseded, the same discipline this report has applied to every other interrupted session (Aug 17, 18, 20, and 21). **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-29_draft) is a NEW, independent FULL WEEKLY refresh** against the last committed baseline (2026-08-22_draft2) — the first cycle in several weeks to surface a genuinely two-sided evidence ledger: a confirmed, crypto-specific sanctions escalation (the Aug 24 "Operation Economic Outcast" package, the first Iran sanctions action to explicitly name digital assets as a sanctionable sector and list 30 on-chain addresses, confirmed via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov) against a confirmed de-escalation upgrade (Oman's own Foreign Ministry, not just Iran, co-confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor Aug 25, confirmed via direct fetch of fm.gov.om). The two roughly offset, alongside a first-of-the-crisis Hormuz transit uptick and a second straight weekly Brent decline on the bull side, and two more tanker incidents plus a firmer casualty count on the bear side. **P HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as a draft, not auto-stamped**, because this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero). See My Decision below. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-31_draft) is a light daily catch-up** covering the Aug 29-31 gap: on Aug 30, US forces struck IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Iran's Larak Island — the first US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29 — directly firing this pillar's own pre-declared flip line ("a

resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper"). Iran retaliated with ballistic missiles on two US-linked Jordan airbases hours later; Jordan intercepted 8 missiles; no confirmed US casualty. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76), front-loaded and held under 8 points per window. This is a light daily touch, not a full weekly refresh, no window moved >8 points, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip vs. the last stamped set — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-01_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Aug 31-Sept 1: escalation continued into a second day — a THIRD Hormuz tanker hit (the VLCC Senegal Prosperity, Aug 31), a disputed Iranian claim of a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base (UAE MoD denies the target claim but confirms it intercepted an Iranian drone over its waters), and Trump on-record Aug 31 still weighing further strikes on Iran. **P RE-RATED DOWN again, more modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — no window moved more than 2 points, well under the 8-point auto-stamp threshold. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority** — the new last COMMITTED baseline. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-02_draft) is a further light daily catch-up that turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since Aug 30:** CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak strike — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a new "tanker for tanker" policy. A US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuhestak, Hormozgan (4+ dead per the Hormozgan governor's office, including a 4-year-old, 60+ injured) — flagged here as SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact level (Iranian state/local authorities; CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it), so it does not by itself move P, but it is the reported trigger for Iran's response: coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile/drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — larger in scale than the single-state Aug 30-31 Jordan strike, but all four are repeat targets, so the "widening to a further NEW state" flip-line clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN sharply to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75), front-loaded and kept under 8 points per window. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026,** retroactively, under Alex's Sept 3 widened delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band flip and the size of a move are no longer disqualifying on their own. The wedding-casualty fact was correctly kept single-narrative-sourced and never used to move P, and nothing about the sourcing or the research itself changed — only the stamping threshold did. This remains the last TRUE committed baseline: 1/9/27/47/74. **Sept 3:** Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Kuwait and UAE — both repeat targets, no US-manned facility hit, widening clause does not fire. **P HELD FLAT. Sept 5, light daily catch-up (2026-09-05_draft):** held flat again — the Reuters weapons-expert corroboration of the Sept 1 wedding strike resolves attribution of an already-priced event, not new escalation; a Sept 5 Iranian-media report of a US strike on the tanker STARK 1 near Kharg Island is single-narrative and not used to move P. **CORRECTION:** that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED," but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here, not corrected retroactively. **Sept 5, FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version:** independently re-verified via WebSearch — the STARK 1 incident is real and developing (Iran International separately obtained video of US radio warnings, and AP itself frames it as an Iranian accusation, not a confirmed fact) but CENTCOM has still not confirmed or denied it, so per the sufficiency rule it is NOT used to move P. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fired this week. **HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY ALEX September 5, 2026. Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft):** CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this report had withheld pending confirmation — and reveals it was materially more serious than known: THREE Iranian tankers (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) struck in retaliation for an unprovoked IRGC ballistic-missile attack on two US Navy warships, both of which evaded. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** — no window moved more than 2 points, no flip-line clause independently fires (no confirmed US casualty, no widening to a new state, Brent short of \$100), and the master call band held Neutral → Neutral. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-08_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 6-8: the new fact is Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei's on-record Sept 6-7 announcement (state TV, Press TV, Tehran Times) that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any vessel that enters — corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, GlobalSecurity.org) but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed ("further details... yet to be announced" per Al Jazeera's Sept 7 explainer). No flip-line clause fires (DCAS still 18, Brent ~\$97.29 Sept 7, no new state). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-09_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 8-9: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship") confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers on Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman) and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days, corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org); both Iranian missile attempts were evaded, no US personnel harmed. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24 (CNBC, ABC News; ~\$100.44, +2.57%) — a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause, but it is the

closest this cycle has come to the flip line. No flip-line clause fires (no US casualty, no new state, only an intraday Brent cross). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-10_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 9-10: two new dated facts. CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq air base — 18 intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org, Jordan's own military). Jordan is a repeat target, so the widening clause does not fire, and both sides confirm no casualties, so the US-casualty clause does not fire either. Separately, Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, SCMP, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), but the same Houthi/Yemen actor already priced, and no strait closure has actually been executed, so this does not independently fire a clause either. Brent has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: above \$101 Sept 9; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but still short of a clean sustained-close call. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral). **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-11_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 10-11: this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES on a third consecutive session — Brent closed Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, its highest since May 19, with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent) — alongside fuller reporting of Iran's Sept 9 shipping wave: 10 vessels attacked near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest declared wave of the war, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. No window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar on every scored fact, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip anywhere. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-12_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 11-12: Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, swept the rest of Yemen's Red Sea coastline by Sept 11 — capturing the final government-held coastal towns (Dhubab, Murad) and Houthi naval forces seizing Mayyun (Perim) Island in the Bab al-Mandeb strait itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — a materially more severe status (actual control of a second global chokepoint's own islands) than the Sept 10 baseline's "closing in" characterization, confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Separately, UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels near Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborating); an IRGC claim of a Sairdron strike is single-source and not used to move P. Yemen is an existing theater, so the widening clause does not fire; no US casualty, so that clause doesn't either — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a fresh clause firing. **P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **LATER THE SAME DAY (Sept 12): a separate FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2), the first full-weekly-depth research dive since the Sept 5 full weekly refresh, ran four parallel adversarial research passes across all four qualitative pillars against the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline (1/2/18/38/70).** One new dated fact clears the sufficiency bar: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, a NEW target distinct from the already-logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes — was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory on Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement/confirmation issued Sept 11). PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com) with satellite imagery of fire/smoke at the pumping stations, plus Iraq's own PM ordering a probe, dismissing the Maysan operations commander, and closing the Shalamchah border crossing. No group has claimed responsibility; President Trump, in Dublin, said Iran was "probably" responsible — a single, hedged, unconfirmed remark, logged as such, NOT as established fact (the Saudi MFA statement itself attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state). Neither flip-line clause fires: the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province — escalation within an existing theater, not a new one), and the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no confirmed US military casualty found); the sustained-Brent->\$100 clause continues to hold (~\$104.61 Sept 12, same as the morning baseline) as persistence, not a fresh trigger. Also logged, not scored: Trump's own account that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen (single-source as to substance, consistent with the already-logged MBS-refused-strikes counterweight), and the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept

12, all members plus Saudi Arabia/Iran/UAE) urging "maximum restraint" over the escalation — a mild long-horizon diplomatic data point relevant only to the 1yr/3yr framing. The Mayyun Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) was independently re-verified as still holding, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge). Sized small given a single infrastructure strike with no widening and no US casualty: **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held, 1mo held at the near-floor 1. **WEEKLY REFRESH — left as DRAFT for Alex's manual review, full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size.** See My Decision below.

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 20% OF MY THESIS (EQUAL, 1/5)

Written June 19, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified September 15, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-15_draft (P **HELD FLAT** at 1/1/18/38/70. Re-checked: the Salalah Iran–GCC ministerial is still priced. Al Jazeera (Sept 14) adds that Saudi Arabia objected to proposed amendments to the Iran–Oman corridor arrangement and Bahrain declined to attend, consistent with what was already scored. TV interested-party assertion, and Brent above \$105 / WTI toward \$102, market prices. No flip-line clause newly fires in either direction.) · COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED · Prior set: Sept 14 light daily touch

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

June column committed by me June 19, 2026 · Aug 8 (cut at 1mo/3mo, full weekly refresh) committed and stamped by Alex · Aug 9-16 are light daily touches, all held flat (no cycle ran Aug 15) · Aug 17-21 drafted but never delivered
HELD FLAT vs. the morning draft) was left as a draft at delivery (full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from auto-stamp) and **COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026**. An Aug 28 daily catch-up draft held P flat but was never released
independently re-researched the week and also HELD P flat at 14/22/38/54/76, left as a draft (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from auto-stamp) pending Alex's manual review — that draft is now superseded and collapsed
up covering Aug 29-31: a resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory (Larak Island, Aug 30) plus an Iranian retaliatory strike on two US-linked Jordan airbases fired this pillar's own pre-declared downside flip line — P cut to 9/17/31
1: escalation continued into a second day — P cut again, more modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75, AUTO-STAMPED, the last COMMITTED set. **This section (score set 2026-09-02_draft) covers Sept 1-2:** the conflict escalated materially
including the war's first direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers; a US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Hormozgan (single-narrative-sourced, not scored directly); Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated strikes (no
fire). **P RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74** — front-loaded, kept under 8 points per window. Originally left as draft Sept 2 pending Alex's manual review (single-narrative core fact, genuinely novel scale, both sides threatened
STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026 once Alex widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy so a call-band flip and move size no longer withhold the stamp on their own — this is the last TRUE committed set. **Sept 3** — Iran's second round of strikes
that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED," but config/scores.json's status was never actually advanced — flagged as a correction, not itself edited. **Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2, this version)** independently re-researched
by CENTCOM, not used to move P); categorically excluded from daily auto-stamp authority, so it went to manual review and is **COMMITTED BY ALEX September 5, 2026**. **Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft2)** independently re-researched
strike as a 3-tanker retaliation for an IRGC missile attack on 2 US Navy warships — no window moved more than 2 points, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral); **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline. **Sept 7**
again to 1/7/24/44/73 on Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei's Sept 6-7 announcement of intent to declare a restricted zone beyond Hormuz into the Persian Gulf — a genuine new escalatory signal, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets; Brent crossed
unchanged (Neutral → Neutral); **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the committed baseline. **Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft, this version)** re-rates P down modestly again to 1/6/23/43/73
Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco, M/T Derya) after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles twice — corroborated by 5+ independent outlets — and Brent crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time
than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline. **Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft)** re-rates P down modestly
for the Sept 8 tanker strike (18 intercepted, no casualties), and Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha, closing in on the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a second chokepoint, but the same actor/theater already priced; Brent crossed
than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the committed baseline. **Sept 11 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-11_draft)** re-rates P down, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72
session (Brent closed above \$107 Thursday Sept 10, highest since May 19), alongside fuller reporting of Iran's 10-vessel Sept 9 Hormuz shipping wave (at least one seafarer killed, not a US service member). No window moved more than 1 point
new last COMMITTED baseline. **Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft)** re-rates P down, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70: Houthi forces swept the rest of Yemen's Red Sea coastline by Sept 11 (capturing Dhubab and al-Hudaydah
strait, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — a second global chokepoint moving from "closing in on" to actual island-level control, confirmed by 6+ independent outlets; separately UKMT0 confirms two more vessels struck near the strait
this is a bigger step than the routine daily grind — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline. **Sept 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2)** independently re-researched the week and also
sufficiency-clearing new fact: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi MFA-confirmed Sept 11, 6+ independent outlets), sponsorship undetermined (Trump's "probably not")
US-casualty clause fires. **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70). **LEFT AS DRAFT — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of source**

WINDOW	JUN	...	8/22 (COMMITTED)	8/31 (COMMITTED)	9/1 (COMMITTED)	9/2 (COMMITTED)	9/5 D2 (COMMITTED)	9/6 (COMMITTED)	9/8 (COMMITTED)	9/9	9/10	9/11 (COMMITTED)	9/12 (COMMITTED)
1 month	50	...	14	9	7	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
3 months	55	...	22	17	15	9	9	8	7	6	5	4	2
6 months	62	...	38	34	32	27	27	25	24	23	22	20	1
1 year	75	...	54	51	50	47	47	45	44	43	42	40	3

3 years	85	...	76	75	75	74	74	73	73	72	72	71	7

Prior committed P (2026-09-14_draft, light daily touch, auto-stamped): 1 / 1 / 18 / 38 / 70 · Current committed P (2026-09-15_draft, light daily touch, auto-stamped, HELD FLAT): 1 / 1 / 18 / 38 / 70 · Weight: 20% (equal) 50/55/62/75/85 (Jun 19) → ... (see prior versions of this report for the full Jul 8–Sept 8 path) → **Sept 8 light daily catch-up (2026-09-08_draft) 1/7/24/44/73** — Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces on-record intent to do yet executed; no flip-line clause fires. No window moved >1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 8, 2026**, the committed baseline → **Sept 9 light daily catch-up** M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco, M/T Derya) in retaliation for a second IRGC missile attack on a US Navy warship, corroborated by 5+ independent outlets; Brent crosses \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24 (CNBC, ABC point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 9, 2026**, the committed baseline → **Sept 10 light daily catch-up (2026-09-10_draft) 1/5/22/42/72** — the IRGC retaliates Houthi forces seize the Yemeni port of Mocha, closing in on the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a second chokepoint, but the same actor/theater already priced; Brent trades above \$100 for a second straight session, still short of a sustained (Neutral → Neutral) — **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 10, 2026**, the committed baseline → **Sept 11 light daily catch-up (2026-09-11_draft) 1/4/20/40/71** — this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" for \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday — its highest in nearly four months, since May 19 — with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — a ~3% give-back; fuller reporting also lands on Iran's Sept 9 shipping wave (10 vessels — 2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of the war; at least one merchant seafarer killed, one missing), which is not a US 22→20, 12mo 42→40, 36mo 72→71. Master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 11, 2026**, the last COMMITTED baseline → **Sept 12 light daily catch-up (2026-09-12_draft)** Mayyun Island (6+ independent outlets), a second global chokepoint moving from "closing in on" to actual island-level control; UKMTO confirms a further two-vessel strike near Khasab, Oman. No new flip-line clause fires (existing t 3mo 4→2, 6mo 20→18, 12mo 40→38, 36mo 71→70. Master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 12, 2026**, the new last COMMITTED baseline → **Sept 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh** Iraqi-origin, sponsorship undetermined); neither flip-line clause fires. **LEFT AS DRAFT — categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority (full weekly refresh) — awaiting Alex's manual review.**

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. **THIS CYCLE (Sept 14, LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-15_draft): RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (from the Sept 13-committed 3/3 the weekend. **Oman News Agency, Sunday September 13:** "It has been decided to postpone to a later date the regional meeting that was to be held on Monday in Salalah, in order to create by Arab News, the Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News and Malay Mail (Sept 13-14). And the absence of Gulf-Arab buy-in is the substance, not the scheduling: **Bahrain explicitly ruled out attacking** **downgraded to a minister of state** rather than its foreign minister. Iran's MFA spokesman says Saudi Arabia requested the postponement citing the Yemen war and calls that a pretext — **SIN** A second dated fact caps the upside of what does survive: FM Araqchi said Sept 13 that the Iran-Oman understanding "**would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz**" (Tehran Times position; echoed Sept 14 by Eurasia Review and Sunday Guardian). Market reaction, reported as a *market price* and not an estimate: Brent past **\$107/bbl (+2.8%, \$107.54 November)** and W surfaced drone strikes on Salalah and Duqm ports; those are dated **March 1, 3 and 11, 2026**, not September, and are NOT treated as new. Windows: 1mo 3→1, 3mo 3→1, 6mo 19→18, 12mo charts drawn and draft joint statement prepared, survives the postponement and Oman's FM publicly recommitted to dialogue), 36mo 70 flat.

Prior cycle (Sept 12, FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-12_draft2): RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70 (from the Sept 12-committed 1/2/18/38/70). Four par 12_draft committed baseline and surfaced ONE sufficiency-clearing new fact beyond that morning baseline (which already covered the Sept 10-11 Bab al-Mandeb/Mayyun Island seizure and t **(Petroline) — the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route — was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory on Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement/confirmation Sept 11),** PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com), with satellite imagery showing fire/smoke at pumping stations near Al Mesba'ah and Al Dhekrat commander, and closed the Shalamchah Iraq-Iran border crossing as a precaution — corroborating, semi-primary. **Attribution caveat, stated carefully:** no group has claimed responsibility; HEDGED, UNCONFIRMED statement, logged as exactly that, NOT as established fact (the Saudi MFA statement itself attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state). **Neither flip** since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province, so this is escalation within an existing theater, not a new one; the US-casualty clause does NOT fire — no confirmed US military casualties ~\$104.61 Sept 12, the same level as the morning baseline) — persistence, not a fresh trigger. **Also logged, not scored:** Trump's own account (same Dublin remarks) that the Houthis privately source as to substance, consistent with (not additive to) the already-logged MBS-twice-refused-strikes restraint counterweight; the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12, all me escalation," calling for "exercising maximum restraint," and expressing concern over attacks on civilian/nuclear infrastructure — a mild, diplomatic, long-horizon data point relevant only to the independently re-verified as still holding, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge); no new UKMTO warning was found beyond the already week, specifically targeting the kingdom's Hormuz-bypass export route, clears the sufficiency bar (a primary Saudi MFA statement plus 6 independent outlets) for a modest further move given no US casualty, so sized small: 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held flat (a single tactical strike doesn't change the long-run strategic outlook, and the BRICS restraint statement is a modest offer reasoned. **This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of move size — LEFT AS DRAFT, flagged prominently for Alex**

Prior cycle (Sept 12 daily, score set 2026-09-12_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70 (from the Sept 11-committed 1/4/20/40/71). **BEARISH and NEW: a second global** forces, having seized the port of Mocha Sept 10 (logged in the Sept 10 baseline as "closing in" on Bab al-Mandeb), continued an offensive that by Sept 11 captured Dhubab and Murad — the Iran-aligned Houthi forces control of Yemen's ENTIRE Red Sea coastline; Houthi naval forces separately seized Mayyun (Perim) Island inside the Bab al-Mandeb strait itself, with fighting continuing (CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald) and is materially more severe than the "closing in" status the Sept 10 cycle priced — actual control of strait-controlling islands in a second global oil Mohammed bin Salman twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused (intelligence/targeting-data support offered instead) — a genuine US-restraint data point. Houthis are an existing theater (not a further NEW state), so the widening clause does not independently fire; no US casualty is claimed or confirmed, so that clause does not fire either — this US-strikes and sustained-Brent clauses both fired in prior cycles), not a fresh flip-line event. **BEARISH and NEW, second fact:** UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 (issued 1910 UTC Sept 10, the UK projectiles struck two vessels roughly 4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire; corroborated by 3+ independent outlets (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill)). **Logged but NOT used** Saildrone Explorer-type unmanned vessel near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM confirmation found. Brent held near/above \$104 for a fifth consecutive session (Sept 12 settle ~\$104.61 already fired Sept 10-11, not a fresh trigger. **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 4→2, 6mo 20→18, 12mo 40→38, 36mo 71→70.** A second chokepoint moving under a past week, sized moderately larger than recent 1-point touches but still restrained since no flip-line newly fires — the sourcing clears the primary-plus-multi-outlet bar (UKMTO's own warning seizure) and verification passed clean, so **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior cycle (Sept 11, score set 2026-09-11_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71 (from the Sept 10-committed 1/5/22/42/72). **BEARISH and NEW — a second, distinct f** Sept 9 intraday cross and the Sept 10 second session came close to but did not cleanly fire, now fires on a third consecutive session: Brent **ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above** — with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent), and Brent was still ~\$104.36 *to the prior cycle:* that cycle, run mid-morning Sept 10, logged Brent at ~\$101.25 "Thursday Sept 10" — an intraday read; Thursday's actual close was far higher, above \$107. **BEARISH and NEW** near Hormuz, 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers, the largest declared wave of shipping attacks by either side since the war began, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause still does NOT fire; no strike on a further new state was confirmed, so the widening clause does not fire either. **Logged but NOT used** Sept 9 against a Kpler 10-day average of 10-13 commodity vessels/day. **Counterweight, also logged:** Friday's give-back is attributed to diplomatic efforts around Hormuz plus the IEA's 2.5 m **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 5→4, 6mo 22→20, 12mo 42→40, 36mo 72→71.** A clause of this pillar's own flip line firing is a real escalation of its evidence standard a reason to withhold the stamp; the sourcing clears the primary-plus-multi-outlet bar and verification passed clean, so **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (au**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 8, score set 2026-09-08_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73 (from the Sept 6-committed 1/8/25/45/73). BEARISH and NEW: Iran's SNS (TV and Tehran Times) that Iran will declare, "in the coming days," a new "restricted zone" beginning at the US Navy's blockade line and extending into the Persian Gulf, with any v corridor agreement would be signed "in the coming days." This is corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity genuine new escalatory signal, but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed: Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be a Consistent with this pillar's past treatment of confirmed-but-not-yet-executed escalatory statements (e.g. Trump's Aug 31 "still weighing further strikes" comment), this is sized as a small conti Sept 4), no widening to a further new state, and Brent closed ~\$97.29/bbl Sept 7 (tradingeconomics.com) — still short of the \$100 sustained-flip threshold. GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) b on Sept 3) is a continuation of the already-priced blockade-enforcement trend, not scored separately. No permanent Iran-Oman corridor deal has been signed (still "in the coming days" per R arrangement). **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo 8→7, 6mo 25→24, 12mo 45→44, 36mo held at 73** (a shipping-zone threat doesn't move the m clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp a stamped)."

Prior to this cycle: P was RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74 (Sept 2, committed Sept 3, then HELD FLAT through Sept 3's Kuwait/UAE repeat-target strikes and the Sept 5 full weekly the Sept 1-committed 7/15/32/50/75) — researched Sept 2, **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** under Alex's widened daily auto-stamp policy. **BEARISH and CONFIRMED exactly the risk this pillar's own Sept 1 note flagged.** CENTCOM confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran Sept 1-2 — IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms, the single Aug 30 Larak Island strike (multi-source: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI). For the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under prior posture of intercepting attacks. Brent rose ~5% Tuesday Sept 1 — its best session in 5 weeks — to ~\$95-96.6/bbl, WTI to ~\$91-92, still short of the \$100 flip line. A US strike on Kukehast governor's office named 4 of at least 5 dead, including a 4-year-old, plus 60+ injured (Al Jazeera, CBS News, Yahoo, UPI). **Flagged EXPLICITLY AS SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core** CENTCOM's Cmdr. Tim Hawkins told CBS News the US has neither confirmed nor denied it — so per the sufficiency rule, this claim alone does not move P, even though multiple Western outlets sourced the fact itself). It is reported here as context for what it triggered: Iran's IRGC launched coordinated ballistic-missile and drone strikes Sept 2 at US-linked bases in FOUR countries simultaneously in retaliation versus the single-state Jordan strike Aug 30-31. But all four are REPEAT targets already struck earlier in this war (Jordan: Jul 28 and Aug 30-31; Bahrain/Kuwait/Iraq: struck at various times to a FURTHER NEW state with confirmed attribution" flip-line clause does NOT fire. Most projectiles were intercepted (Jordan: roughly 10 of 25 intercepted, 3 landed with no reported casualties). combat death has been found as of this run — so neither the casualty clause nor the widening clause independently fires either. The already-fired (Aug 30) "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran" further down this cycle. Both sides are now on-record threatening larger future action: President Trump threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed senior US official (CNBC) — read as continued war-escalation risk, not de-escalation. The cut is front-loaded and kept under the 8-point/window auto-stamp threshold: 1mo 7→1, 3mo 15→9, 6mo 32→27, 12mo 50→32. **reasons:** (1) the wedding-casualty fact — the emotional and political driver of today's four-country retaliation — is single-narrative-sourced even though widely reported, so confidence in today's (nearly 100 targets, first-ever direct tanker strikes) is a genuinely novel escalation beyond this pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedent; (3) both sides' on-record threats of much larger responses. master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band (Mild Bull → Neutral) versus the last stamped set, which under the then-current rules disqualified auto-stamp on its own. **On September 3, 2026, call-band flip and move size are no longer disqualifying by themselves.** The underlying sourcing and sufficiency-rule handling are unchanged — the wedding-casualty claim still was not u

STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026. See My Decision below for the full reasoning.

CoinPicks · September 15, 2026 · Research & Education · Not Financial Advice

to the already-established pattern. CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper gave an on-record briefing Aug 28 (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, Iran lanes; ~1,500 commercial vessels have transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since new shock. IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing, corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the upper shock. **BULLISH and CONFIRMED: Oman's own Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a Hormuz corridor, Aug 25.** Directly fetched from fm.gov.om/en/53722 (Oman's own government site) — Oman had not confirmed it; now Oman's own ministry co-hosts the statement. Terms: a temporary 7-mile-wide joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), a joint mine-clear "Islamabad Memorandum." Still explicitly described as "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance with the lapsed June MoU. No public fee/revenue of an Iran-Oman revenue-sharing deal remains single-source and unconfirmed by Oman — correctly excluded from scoring, same treatment as prior single-source claims. Trump declared the France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack above. The first quantified Hormuz transit-volume increase of the entire crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week 2 independent pieces Aug 21 & Aug 28) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29→42); still a small fraction (~10-15%) of the ~110-130/day (~770-910/week) pre-war baseline, but ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further away from the \$100/bbl flip line, with press explicit combat death Aug 22-29 (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the standing casualty total, not a new event GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike. **Net assessment: the new escalation and the new de-escalation roughly offset** a full clean week without a new attack/fatality/seizure — is NOT met, since the Aug 27 attack breaks the "clean week" clause and the corridor deal remains Iran+Oman only (not US-accepted). in either direction: P HELD FLAT on all five windows.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. This cycle's load-bearing fact — the Petroline pipeline drone strike — is corroborated by a primary Saudi Ministry of Foreign Affairs statement plus OilPrice.com), well above the sufficiency bar; the single-source Trump "probably Iran" attribution is explicitly NOT used to move P. The prior cycle's load-bearing fact — the Bab al-Mandeb chokepoint (News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald), and the Khasab vessel strikes remain confirmed via UKMTO's own official warning plus 3+ independent outlets. Quality (the 0-1 input) is unchanged. **Impact** — 8 out of 10, the uniform value shared by every pillar in the equal-weight model. BTC traded at \$76,916.53 on Sept 14, firming from \$76,808.69 on Sept 13 and \$77,269.22 on Sept 12; evidence turned back negative; per house discipline this pillar's score is not adjusted to chase or match the tape either way. For context, BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2, down from \$78,031.44 on Sept 1, moved sharply negative.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated September 12, 2026 (full weekly refresh, re-checked Sept 12, P re-rated down further, modestly, as a third Saudi oil-infrastructure strike lands with sponsorship undetermined)

This cycle (Sept 12, full weekly refresh): the crowd will likely either read the Petroline pipeline strike as proof Iran is now hitting Saudi Arabia's core oil-export infrastructure directly, or dismiss it as going further than the facts support. **Me:** the honest read sits between those: a drone strike launched from Iraqi soil hit a NEW kind of target (Saudi Arabia's primary Hormuz-bypass export artery, not a tanker; attribution — is what earns a further small cut. I am explicit that Trump's Dublin remark is a single hedged guess, not evidence, and score accordingly: the move is small (3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each) but is already an active theater since the Sept 1 Erbil strike) and no US casualty — not because I am siding with either the "Iran did it" or "no proof, ignore it" framings. The BRICS restraint declaration is a counterweight, because a system that only reports escalation isn't honest either.

Prior cycle (Sept 12 daily): the crowd will likely either treat the Bab al-Mandeb island seizures as a headline-grabbing new front that should crater risk assets, or dismiss it as "just Yemen" background noise; more than a routine tanker strike is structural, not emotional — Iran-aligned forces now hold actual chokepoint-controlling islands in a SECOND global oil corridor, not merely "closing in" on one; the US technically fires (Yemen is existing theater, no US casualty). I am sizing this cut larger than the recent 1-point daily touches for exactly that reason, while still stopping short of treating it as a flip-line move, rather be criticized for under-reacting to a real structural shift than for inventing a new flip-line clause after the fact to justify a bigger move. The MBS-request-refused detail is logged honestly below.

Prior cycle (Sept 11): the crowd will read a \$108 print and a 6% up-day in Brent as the war finally repricing energy — or, watching Friday's 3% give-back on Hormuz diplomacy headlines, wave that off as a specific, falsifiable clause — a *sustained* Brent close above \$100 — and three consecutive sessions above it, including a close above \$107, is that clause firing, not a near-miss. I said so in the two sessions prior. What it does *not* do is change what the war is: still no confirmed US combat death since Sept 4, still no strike on a further new state, and the one death in the Sept 9 shipping wave is a change — and the give-back on diplomacy headlines is logged honestly alongside it.

Prior cycle (Sept 10): the crowd is likely to either read the Al Azraq missile barrage as a dangerous new peak of the conflict, or wave off a Yemeni port city changing hands as background noise to a US-linked airbase sounds large in isolation, but Jordan has now absorbed this kind of strike repeatedly since Jul 28, and both CENTCOM and Jordan's own military confirm no casualties this time. I am interesting precisely because it's easy to dismiss: it's the same actor this pillar has tracked in the Red Sea/Bab al-Mandeb theater for months, so it doesn't independently widen the war, but "closing in" on a new target, though no blockade has actually been executed yet. Brent trading above \$100 for a second straight session is the more important tell than either strike — not yet a sustained close, but the clear trend is down modestly again (1/5/22/42/72, from 1/6/23/43/72), consistent with the sizing this pillar has used for every cycle since Sept 6.

Prior cycle (Sept 9): the crowd is likely to either read Brent's intraday \$100 cross as confirmation the flip line has effectively fired, or dismiss the 5-tanker CENTCOM strike as "more of the same" and wave that off as a session is a real data point and the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but it is explicitly not the same thing as a sustained close above \$100, which is what this pillar's own pre-declared threshold for every relevant section below rather than being quietly dropped. The CENTCOM-confirmed 5-tanker strike is a larger single incident than the 3-tanker strike this pillar priced on Sept 6, but it is the same provocation (an IRGC missile attack on a US Navy warship) — a continuation of an already-priced trajectory, not a new category of event, so I am re-rating down modestly again (1/6/23/43/72, from 1/7/24/44/73).

Prior cycle (Sept 8): the crowd is likely to either dismiss Rezaei's restricted-zone announcement as Iran "talking tough" without follow-through, or treat it as an imminent full closure of a new strait; a shipping across an expanded zone is a real escalatory signal worth logging and worth a small cut, but it is not yet an executed act — no boundaries, no enforcement mechanism, and no confirmed escalation from 1/8/25/45/73) rather than sharply, because none of this pillar's flip-line clauses fire on it (no US casualty, no new state, Brent short of \$100) and it is consistent with — not a departure from — the pillar's explicitly not treating Rezaei's parallel claim that an Iran-Oman corridor deal will also be signed "in the coming days" as bullish either — until it is actually signed, it's the same "very close" pattern.

Prior cycle (Sept 6): the crowd was likely to read CENTCOM's own confirmation of the Sept 5 tanker strike as a relief ("finally, official clarity") rather than what it actually was — a confirmation that the US interdicted, but an unprovoked IRGC ballistic-missile attack on two US Navy warships that the US answered by destroying three tankers. Re-rated down modestly (1/8/25/45/73, from 1/9/27/47/74), because no new state, Brent short of \$100) and the escalation — while more serious than previously known — was still a continuation of the same "resumption of direct US strikes" trajectory already priced on the tanker/vessel/drone strikes were explicitly not used to move P — those are Iran's own claims, unconfirmed by the US, and the sufficiency rule is exactly what stops a claim like that from doing more.

The crowd: is likely to anchor on the wedding-strike casualty claim as the emotional center of today's news, and either (a) treat it as a confirmed atrocity driving the story, or (b) dismiss the whole thing as wrong. The scale of the underlying US strike wave (nearly 100 targets, first-ever direct tanker strikes) is independently, multi-source confirmed regardless of how the casualty dispute resolves, and no change.

Me: cutting sharply to 1/9/27/47/74, versus the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped). This is the largest single-cycle P move this pillar has made since the Aug 30-31 flip-line-firing cut, and I am drafting and flagging it prominently for Alex's manual review. Three reasons, stated plainly: (1) the core wedding-casualty fact — the political and emotional driver of today's four-country Iranian retaliation (CENTCOM neither confirming nor denying), even though it's widely reported; my confidence in today's sizing is lower than for a cleanly multi-sourced primary event, and I don't want to self-approve the war's first direct tanker strikes — is a genuinely novel escalation this pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedents (Jul 28 Jordan, Aug 30 Larak) don't cleanly cover, and sizing a cut for a genuinely novel event can be quietly self-approved; (3) both sides are now on-record threatening much larger responses ahead — a miscalibrated cut here is more costly than usual given what could follow. That said, the crowd's country retaliation does NOT independently fire the widening-to-a-new-state flip-line clause because all four targets are repeats.

My edge: the discipline here is refusing to let a single-source emotional fact do more work than it's earned, in either direction — not discarding it (it's genuinely the trigger for today's retaliation) but not independently-confirmed facts (strike count, tanker strikes, four-country retaliation, mutual escalation threats) support on their own. The crowd either over- or under-reacts to a claim like this; this pillar's edge is to not.

Honesty check against the tape: BTC fell from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp) to \$76,581.44 (Sept 2) — a real, visible risk-off move that for once tracks the same direction as this pillar's own sharp move. It does not match BTC's move — it scores evidence, not price action — but the comparison itself is logged here explicitly as an honesty check for the reader.

The Facts

As of September 12, 2026 — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2) vs the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline (this morning's light daily catch-up); this cycle's final score is still load-bearing).

★ ★ **NEW — Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline), the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed strikes. Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate against Iraq. OilPrice.com — 6+ independent, satellite imagery of fire/smoke at the pumping stations). Iraq's PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, and closed the Shalamcheh oil field.**

- **Attribution caveat, stated carefully:** no group has claimed responsibility for the pipeline strike; the Saudi MFA statement attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state. Presumably UNCONFIRMED remark, NOT treated as established fact.
- **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire.
- **Counterweight, logged:** Trump's own account (same Dublin remarks) that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen — single-source as to substance, corroborated by BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12, all members plus Saudi Arabia, Iran, and UAE) called for "exercising maximum restraint" and voiced concern over attacks on civilian/nuclear facilities used to move P.
- **Re-verified independently:** the Mayyun (Perim) Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) still holds, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, Zee News, etc.) Warning 133-26.

Carried forward from the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12 draft, auto-stamped — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW — Houthi forces complete their sweep of Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline (capturing Dhubab and Murad by Sept 11, the last government-held coastal towns) and seize Mocha Island** — a second global oil chokepoint moving from "closing in on" to actual island-level control (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald — 6+ independent). Yemen's control of Mocha is confirmed by a second source (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill — 4 independent). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does not fire.
- **Counterweight, logged:** Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused — intelligence/targeting-data support of US policy.
- ★ ★ **NEW — UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 (issued 1910 UTC Sept 10) confirms four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire** (Gulf News, etc.)
- **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P:** IRGC's own claim to have separately struck a US Navy Saildrone Explorer-type unmanned vessel near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM confirmation.
- **Brent held near/above \$104 for a fifth consecutive session** (settled ~\$104.61 Sept 12, TradingEconomics/psuconnect.in) — confirming persistence of the already-fired "sustained >\$100" flip-line clause.
- **BTC traded at \$76,916.53 on Sept 14** — up 1.4% from \$76,808.69 on Sept 13, which itself eased from \$77,269.22 on Sept 12 (local run.py quant refresh).
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — the "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES: Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107, after trading above \$108 intraday** — Brent was still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, roughly 9% higher on the week despite a ~3% give-back (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics Sept 10-11, Vantage Markets, etc.) Brent closes and one decisively so. *Correction:* the prior cycle, run mid-morning Sept 10, logged ~\$101.25 as "Thursday Sept 10" — that was an intraday read, not the close.
- ★ ★ **NEW — fuller reporting of the Sept 9 shipping wave: Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of shipping attacks since 1979** (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill — 4 independent). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does not fire.
- **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P:** a compilation of Hormuz transit data puts throughput at 7 transits on Sept 9 against a Kpler 10-day moving average of 10-13 commodity vessels per day. The report cannot move a P under the house sufficiency rule.
- **Counterweight, logged:** Friday Sept 11's ~3% Brent give-back is attributed to diplomatic efforts around the Strait of Hormuz and to the IEA's forecast of a 2.5 mb/d contraction in 2026 demand. The report does not either.
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, in retaliation for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike** — casualties (Al Jazeera Sept 9, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement) — clears the sufficiency bar. Jordan is a repeat target (struck Aug 30-31), so the widening clause does not fire.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait**, a SECOND global shipping chokepoint (Reuters via Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail). Same actor/theater already priced; no strait closure or interdiction has actually been confirmed — outlets describe Houthi control.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session**, more persistent than Sept 9's single-day intraday cross (CNBC: above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9). The prior cycle has come to this pillar's "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line clause, but still short of a clean multi-session sustained call.
- **NEW — no widening to a further new state and no confirmed US casualty:** Jordan is a repeat target, and CENTCOM/Jordan both confirm no casualties from the Al Azraq strike; DCAS remains silent (checked and rejected as uncorroborated against CENTCOM's own statement).
- **BTC traded at \$77,063 on Sept 11** — down from \$77,993.99 on Sept 10 and \$79,052.40 on Sept 9 (local full quant refresh this cycle, run .py quant).

Carried forward from Sept 9 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW — CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Dabir** — **TWICE over the preceding two days.** Corroborated across 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own press release ("US Navy warships destroyed five Iranian oil tankers" Sept 8). The report clears the sufficiency bar.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24**, trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC "Brent crude tops \$100 as US strikes Iranian oil tankers" Sept 9). Not a sustained close, so it does not independently fire this pillar's "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line clause; the closest this cycle has come to it.
- **NEW — both Iranian missile attempts on the US Navy warship were evaded, no US personnel harmed** — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired.
- **NEW — no widening to a further new state:** Gulf of Oman and Kharg Island are both existing theater already struck in this war.
- **Iran's Sept 6-7 SNSC "restricted zone" announcement remains not-yet-executed** — no new dated development, not re-scored a second time.
- **BTC traded at \$79,052.40 on Sept 9** — up from \$78,435.62 on Sept 8 and \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 8 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" beyond the Strait of Hormuz "in the coming days."** The zone would be placed on Iran's sanctions list. Corroborated across 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own press release.
- **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced." Rezaei separately said an IIRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels would be the start of this research pass.
- **GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) tracker puts the blockade count at 92 vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded** — up from Day 190's 87/3/2 (Sept 3), a continuation of the already-priced.
- **BTC traded at \$78,435.62 on Sept 8** — down from \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 and \$80,338.98 on Sept 6 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 6 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5, resolving the tanker report this pillar had withheld previously** (permanently disabled near Jask), and M/T Kylo (completely destroyed in the Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a destroyer) and killing US personnel. Corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other independent outlets, in addition to CENTCOM's own release.
- ★ **This revealed a materially more serious escalation than the Sept 5 baseline knew:** not a quiet single-tanker interdiction, but a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels and the shooting of two of our ships, we will impose an even higher economic cost — taking out three of yours."
- **Sept 6's IRGC claims of further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels and a US naval drone** (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remain US-unconfirmed as of this cycle.
- **BTC traded at \$79,929.30 on Sept 6** — up from \$79,646.11 on Sept 5 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 2 (re-verified through the Sept 5 full weekly refresh and this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, roughly 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak Island strike.** Targets included IRGC air-defense sites, radar installations, and missile launchers. Multi-source corroborated: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI.
- ★ ★ **NEW — for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under a newly reported Trump-approved "tanker for tanker" policy** — to direct strikes on Iranian state vessels.

- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Brent rose ~5% Tuesday Sept 1, its best session in 5 weeks, to ~\$95-96.6/bbl; WTI to ~\$91-92** — still short of the \$100/bbl flip line.
- ★ ★ **NEW, FLAGGED SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED** — **a US strike on Kuestak, Sirik County, Hormozgan (near the Strait) reportedly hit a wedding party.** The Hormozgan governor's claim (via CBS News, Yahoo, UPI report the claim). CENTCOM's Cmdr. Tim Hawkins told CBS News the US has neither confirmed nor denied it. The casualty claim itself originates with Iranian state/local authorities, but is multi-sourced. Per the sufficiency rule, this claim alone does NOT move P; it is reported as context for the retaliation it triggered.
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated ballistic-missile and drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries simultaneously: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait** — strike Aug 30-31 — but all four are REPEAT targets already struck earlier in this war (Jordan: Jul 28, Aug 30-31; Bahrain/Kuwait/Iraq: struck at various points Feb-Jul 2026), so the "widening to" clause is not applicable.
- **NEW** — **most projectiles were intercepted:** Jordan (~10 of 25 intercepted, 3 landed, no reported casualties); Bahrain (most of roughly two dozen drones intercepted). No confirmed new US strikes, nor the widening clause independently fires.
- **NEW** — **both sides now on-record threatening larger future action:** President Trump threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed senior Iranian military official threatened continued escalation risk, not de-escalation.
- **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2** — down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 (Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.

Carried forward from the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting.** The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles on Aug 31, hitting the side, engine room, and ballast tank. No casualties, no environmental impact reported; UKMTO-logged. This follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25) incidents.
- ★ **Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES that base was targeted while CONFIRMING a separate cross-border drone incident.** The UAE MoD explicitly denied Al Minhad was targeted, while separately confirming its air force intercepted an Iranian drone detected over UAE territorial waters, approaching from Iraq. The claim is reported by CBS News, Al Jazeera, Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Seatrade Maritime, and Iran International.
- ★ **President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran**, calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — on-record, multi-source) — explicitly not a decision.
- **Brent crude continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday per multiple market-desk reports)** on fresh-clash fears — the session after the long Labor Day weekend, the second straight cycle.
- **Jordan was struck again Aug 30-31**, but remained a repeat, not a "further new," state per this pillar's own framing (already struck Jul 28 and again as part of the Aug 30 IRGC retaliation) — not a widening.
- **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 on Sept 1** — down from \$78,447.16 on Aug 31 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory, Aug 30, CONFIRMED via on-record CENTCOM spokesperson plus 20+ independent outlets.** US forces struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Aug 30, hitting the Strait — Capt. Tim Hawkins (CENTCOM) confirmed on the record; corroborated by Bloomberg, CNBC, NBC News, Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch, and others. This is the first direct US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-consecutive-clean-night streak. **Directly fired this pillar's own pre-declared flip line** ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran") — not a widening.
- ★ **IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases, Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED via Jordan's own military statement plus multi-source reporting.** IRGC said it struck two airbases on Aug 30-31, hitting the bases and surrounding areas. It intercepted 8 missiles; Iran claims "heavy damage" to base infrastructure, unconfirmed by the US or Jordan beyond the interception — logged as Iran-sourced, not scored as fact. IRGC separately confirmed the strikes.
- **Press (Reuters/CNBC) framed the renewed exchange as weighing on Asian equities and US futures**, reversing the prior two-week Brent decline.
- **BTC traded at \$78,447.16 on Aug 31** — up from \$77,666.16 on Aug 29 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov.** Press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iran's Financial System") and recent-actions entry dated 20260824 — corroborated by state.gov and 3+ independent trade-compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets (TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client reports from Singapore, and Switzerland under five EO 13902 sectoral determinations. **For the first time, digital assets was explicitly named as a sanctionable sector** — 30 crypto addresses across Bitcoin, Ethereum, and Tether. This is real, primary-confirmed, and directly crypto-relevant. Continued Aug 28 with a new Bank Melli-Dubai designation.
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722.** A genuine upgrade: in every prior cycle, the US and Oman ministry co-hosts the joint statement. Terms: a temporary 7-mile-wide joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), a joint mine-clearing project, and continuing technical talks. The "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance with the lapsed June MoU. No public fee/revenue terms were disclosed; a separate IRGC spokesman said Oman — correctly excluded.
- **NEW** — **two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents.** Aug 24, off Oman's coast (engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties, UKMTO); Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished, no casualties, UKMTO).
- **NEW** — **CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28** (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): US forces cleared Iran's waters of ~1,500 commercial vessels have transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade began; US forces cleared Iran's waters of ~1,500 commercial vessels have transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade began.
- **NEW** — **IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing, corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead** (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the highest toll in the history of the Strait.
- **NEW** — **Trump declared the Strait "demined" Aug 25** with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack.
- **NEW** — **the first quantified Hormuz transit-volume increase of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 17-23** (USNI News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quantified a 30%+ increase over the prior week (westbound 29→42). Still a small fraction (~10-15%) of the ~110-130/day (~770-910/week) pre-war baseline, but a genuine first uptick.
- **NEW** — **Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further from the peak.
- **NEW** — **no new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29** (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the statistics).
- **NEW** — **no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found** — GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike.
- **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 on Aug 29** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 on Aug 22 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the abandoned Aug 28 draft (2026-08-28_draft — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; re-confirmed independently this cycle, not taken on faith): the two Aug 24/Aug 27 tanker incidents and the Iran claim was also first flagged there as not-used. All re-verified fresh this cycle.

Carried forward from the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23 — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Casualty toll (as of Aug 22): real, but a range, not a point figure.** That cycle cross-checked the cumulative Hormuz-campaign death toll directly: Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" page (last updated Aug 22) lists at least 15; IMO's own "Middle East Highlighted Incidents" page (fetched directly) shows 19 seafarer fatalities across 68 incidents as of Aug 21, but appears to aggregate the broader Middle East region, not the Hormuz campaign cleanly. Honest range: **15-19 cumulative deaths, 17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers** — now settled higher by this cycle's IMO six-month count.
- **No new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22.** Independent re-checking for vessel strikes, seizures, or Iran-related military incidents in that window found nothing beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline.
- **The UAE missile-attack claim reconciles to the same known Aug 18 episode, not a new one.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) described a missile attack on a UAE ship, but flagged as a possible miss; on reconciliation it is the same episode already in the draft baseline (CBS/CNN/AI Jazeera, Aug 18 strike / Aug 19 embargo response) — a one-day cross-outlet data discrepancy, not a new claim. The possible "false flag" — genuinely disputed, both sides single-source on their own claims.
- **CENTCOM's blockade/interdiction tally was climbing incrementally as of Aug 22** (68 vessels redirected vs. ~67 shortly before) — now superseded by this cycle's Aug 28 briefing above.

- **The Iran-Oman single-corridor deal remained unsigned as of Aug 22;** the underlying 60-day US-Iran negotiation window (from the June 17 Versailles MOU) expired Aug 17 without a compromise (still not a comprehensive, US-accepted deal).
- **Brent was ~\$93-95/bbl as of Aug 20-21,** a second straight weekly gain (~6%), the highest since late July — now reversed by this cycle's two-week Brent decline above.
- **Strait of Hormuz traffic: trackers disagreed on the exact daily transit count as of Aug 22** (estimates ranged ~1% to ~20% of the pre-war ~130-170/day baseline) — now superseded by this cycle's (draft2) item above.

From the Aug 22 morning draft (score set 2026-08-22_draft) — carried forward, casualty framing softened above:

- ★ **★ NEW — a fatal strike on the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign's latest victim (CORRECTED: not the first fatality, contrary to this draft's earlier framing).** The Liberia-flagged bulk carrier *Al-Sayid* was struck in the engine room while exiting the Strait's southern corridor, Aug 17-18; the chief engineer was killed. UKMTO's report is corroborated by 7+ independent outlets (Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping, etc.) **this cycle (draft2): the cumulative toll is a 15-19 range, not a clean figure** — see the NEW (draft2) item above. This report's own prior cycles never surfaced or scored on that toll — flagging rather than auto-stamped.
- ★ **★ NEW — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22.** The Liberia-flagged tanker *Amara* was boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17; Iran's Fars News says it's held for non-payment under Iranian Shipping News) — a shift from attacks-only to active enforcement and detention.
- ★ **Correction to the record:** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only; Iran denies, calls it a possible "false flag") and is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE's Fujairah port May 4, both predating this incident. That "novel escalation vector" framing is not carried forward.
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran since the Aug 1 stand-down** (GlobalSecurity Day-175 tracker) — the pause holds, a modest stabilizing factor.
- **Sanctions remain mostly rhetoric.** Treasury Secretary Bessent has repeatedly promised the "toughest sanctions in history" / to "collapse Iran's economy," with the actual package pushed to an adjacent designation of 10 Hezbollah-linked individuals/networks — real, but narrower than the promised Iran-economy package, which has not yet been unveiled.
- **Brent ~\$93-95/bbl (Aug 21)** (TradingEconomics, Vantage, Fortune) — up modestly on sanctions anticipation, still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **Iran said Aug 22 it will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait** (state media) — a mild, narrow normalizing signal amid otherwise hardening posture.
- **Mediation continues without a breakthrough;** Qatar/Oman still pushing diplomacy. Tehran "dismissed" Trump's sanctions threats Aug 21 and called the new sanctions a "declaration of war."
- **No new confirmed US combat death found in this window.**
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 on Aug 22** — up +7.4% from Aug 20's close of \$71,882.92 (Bitstamp). See The Claim for the honesty check on this divergence from the pillar's own evidence.

Carried forward from Aug 18-20 (still load-bearing — the UAE "novel escalation" framing is corrected above, not repeated here):

- **The UAE reported Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory Aug 18; Iran denies it, calling it a possible "false flag."** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (Aug 18) report the UAE says one missile hit a live, unresolved, single-source-attributed dispute, reported as such, not used alone to move P.
- **The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran, announced Aug 19** (CNN, Washington Post, Fortune) — a dated, corroborated, structural response, independent of separate Aug 19-dated reporting (NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing this same missile attack and embargo was initially flagged as a possible second incident by this cycle's draft2 item above.
- **A commercial vessel was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait, Aug 18,** causing engine damage and one crew injury (UK Maritime Trade Operations).
- **The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned as of Aug 20-22.** Iran claims route coordinates were agreed Aug 18; Oman has not confirmed.

Carried forward from Aug 16-18 (independently re-verified against fresh primary sources this cycle — all confirmed accurate, still load-bearing):

- ★ **The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed Monday, Aug 18, without a signed deal.** CBS News's live desk (direct-fetched) reports the deadline expired that day; Iran's foreign ministry downplayed the "shortly after its June 18 signing" — the first time either side has publicly framed the other as already in breach, rather than "very close." Trump told reporters he has "no time schedule" to resolve the dispute.
- ★ **Trump threatened Oman.** In a Fox News interview (Aug 17, per CBS's live desk), Trump said the US would take action if Oman "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait, and that "we'd handle it ourselves, not through a mediator, as a potential target. This followed Iran announcing its own agreement with Oman on shipping routes through the Strait.
- ★ **Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed further.** CBS News's live desk, citing maritime monitors, reports only 3-5 vessel transits over the Aug 15-16 weekend, versus 31 the prior weekend; CENTCOM (previously cited). *Note: the pre-war baseline cited in the Aug 18 draft (~130/day) was independently re-checked this cycle; the more defensible figure is closer to ~110/day. The discrepancy is flagging under either baseline.*
- **Brent rose to ~\$90.9-91.0/bbl (Aug 17-18)** — up 2.7% on Aug 17 per Yahoo Finance/Fortune/TradingEconomics, from the \$87-90 range priced in Aug 13-16 — still well under the \$100 flip line (per above).
- **BTC closed at \$64,285.10 on Aug 18** — +2.1% vs. Aug 16's close of \$62,937.03 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from Aug 14-16 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Three ADNOC tanker incidents in 48 hours (Aug 14-15), comparable in kind to the established pattern.** The UAE accused Iran/IRGC of striking two ADNOC vessels Aug 14 (Al Jazeera, no injuries — an "unknown projectile"). Iran did not claim direct responsibility either time; UAE's Foreign Ministry called it "piracy." No new state targeted, no casualties at the time —

Carried forward from Aug 11-14 (still load-bearing):

- **Aug 13 — Hormuz deal remains unsigned, stuck on hardened compensation demands from both sides.** Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, and The Hill (six independent outlets) reported the UAE's demand for compensation for war damages, asset unfreezing, and sanctions relief; Trump separately amended his own compensation demand to include damages "to the people of Lebanon, Syria, Yemen, and Iraq."
- **Brent eased to ~\$87-90/bbl** (from the \$98-100+ spikes logged in late July) as Hormuz traffic stayed low as of Aug 13-14; a live tracker (straits.live) showed the Strait at "day 166" of closure —
- **Aug 13 — Araghchi again called the Hormuz deal "very close" while conditioning full reopening on the US "making amends" over the June MoU** (CNN, NPR, Al Jazeera, France 24, Bloomberg) — a compensation-dispute read.
- ★ **Aug 11 — a Houthi "double-tap" missile strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait (Red Sea, not Hormuz) killed 6 (4 crew, 2 rescue workers)** per Yemeni government reports — a genuinely lethal incident, but in the same Houthi-proxy Red Sea theater and comparable in kind to the Aug 8 ADNOC tanker hit and Aug 9 Jazan refinery strike already logged without moving P.
- **Iran's Supreme Leader reshuffled top military leadership (new armed-forces chief of staff, new IRGC commander)** — a structural development with an ambiguous, not-yet-legible direct impact on the Strait.
- ★ **Houthi forces drone-struck Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery on Aug 9,** a 400,000 bpd facility on Saudi Arabia's Red Sea coast. NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba (six independent outlets) reported the strike and firefighters extinguished the resulting fire the same day, with no announced extended production impact.

Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iranian FM Araqchi says the Oman shipping-route deal is "very close" but conditions full reopening on new demands, including US compensation to Iran.** Reuters (via Investing.com) reported the deal "are "very close" to an agreement on a new shipping route through the strait, but that reopening it would depend on further conditions, and that the previous shipping traffic separation scheme was "not a permanent solution."
- ★ **The UAE says Iran struck another ship in the strait; Oman condemns "repeated attacks."** The same Reuters report: the UAE separately reported a fresh Iranian strike on a vessel transiting the Strait of Hormuz without assigning blame, and described negotiations with Iran as "positive and constructive."

Carried forward from Aug 1-8 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents, Jul 31 - Aug 5, that daily two-day checks missed or undercounted.** The LNG carrier *Gaslog Shanghai* was struck and disabled carrying LNG from Iran; the carrier *Minoan Pioneer* was struck in the engine room, suffering a blackout with one crew member missing (Aug 3); two more explosions were reported near Kumzar (Aug 5). The IMO's cumulative tally of incidents in the Strait of Hormuz described as "at a trickle."

★ **Aug 7 — the Iran-Oman joint statement remained unsigned as of that check, still in final drafting.** Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei described the statement outlining agreed process."

- ★ **Aug 6 — Iran and Oman reached an "understanding in principle" on the Hormuz route map.** Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi told IRNA: "an understanding in principle and exit routes" — confirmed by Bloomberg (two articles), CBS, Al Jazeera (two articles), Euronews, and Military.com.
- ★ **Aug 6 — the fee dispute first surfaced as the remaining obstacle.** Iran is seeking fees of 5-7% of cargo value from transiting ships; Oman is discussing fees around 3%; Washington wants separately reports sources saying the proposed passage deal is "not feasible for shipping industry."

- ★ **Aug 1 — the first quiet night in days.** [globalsecurity.org](#)'s day-by-day war tracker reported no new US strikes on Iran overnight Jul 31 following the heavy Jul 29-30 wave; Brent fell ~2% on shipping protection was reported drawing backing from 14 countries.
- ★ **Aug 1-2 — fresh, multi-source-corroborated attacks on Hormuz shipping.** Bloomberg: a Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) was struck while transiting the Strait. UKMTO/[globalsecurity.org](#) engine room damaged and the vessel disabled. These directly contradicted the Aug 1 "quiet night" framing — the pause was not durable.
- **Aug 2 — the Saudi-led naval coalition kept solidifying.** Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, and Tribune reported 14 confirmed member countries and 43 nations represented at a first distinct from any single day's attack-or-lull headline.
- ★ **Aug 4 — Trump canceled a planned joint US-Israeli strike on Iranian energy infrastructure.** Multiple outlets (NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN) reported the cancellation 1-2 weekend, reportedly including a full Strait of Hormuz reopening. No US strikes on Iran proper have been reported since the cancellation.
- **Aug 4 — Iran continues to deny any direct US talks.** Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei: "we currently have no negotiations with the United States; the negotiations are with Oman." [Trumpposts.com](#)
- ★ **Aug 4 — a bulker was struck by a projectile and suffered a full blackout in the Strait** ([globalsecurity.org](#), [iransitrep.com](#)) — active attacks continued even as the diplomatic framework was being established.
- ★ **Aug 5 — the first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal.** Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, and Al-Quds report the US, Iran, and Oman nearing an agreement on a median lane in Omani waters, no tolls or transit fees during the interim period, and a plan to clear naval mines from the median lane within 30 days. The US aimed to announce the deal Aug 6.
- **Aug 5 — still unsigned.** CNN quotes a Gulf official putting the odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday at only 50-50. The Strait remains formally impassable to normal traffic pending finalization of the deal.
- **BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5** — up ~1.7% from the \$63,579.68 close on Jul 31, continuing its resilience through a week where the war's own risk signal moved both up and down.

- ★ **The lull was real, then it broke: Iran's IRGC struck a US/CENTCOM base at Muwaffaq Salti, Jordan (Jul 28).** Confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNN, Axios, RT, JPost) — b. defenses, **zero US casualties**. This came after a genuine 2-3 day pause in CENTCOM strikes (Jul 25-27) and on the same day Trump was publicly touting "very friendly" talks with Netanyahu at the White House.
- ★ **The US retaliated with a "heavy wave of strikes" (Jul 29)** — explosions reported at Bandar Abbas, Kish Island, Qeshm Island, and Khuzestan Province (CNN). Trump: "it's our turn to hit them" — war pulls in more countries."
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Iraq: US and Saudi Arabia conducted joint strikes on Iran-backed Popular Mobilisation Forces across Iraq (Jul 29),** CENTCOM-confirmed, hitting sites in Baghdad, Wasit, and Tikrit (BBC, Reuters, AP, CNN, Foreign Policy, 5+ outlets). Iraq's government called it a "flagrant violation of sovereignty." This is Saudi Arabia's first turn as a direct co-belligerent in this war. A claim that "six Iranian IRGC advisors were killed" is not corroborated.
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Egypt: a drone hit a US-owned FSRU vessel and a tanker at Egypt's Damietta port (Jul 29)** — the first strike on Egyptian soil in this war (Al Jazeera, CNBC, Times of Israel). No confirmed US involvement — attribution remains unresolved.
- **Brent rebounded from the lull-low.** Brent fell to ~\$90/bbl (-6.7%) during the Jul 25-27 lull, then rose back to ~\$92-93/bbl by Jul 30 (+~3.5% day-over-day, +24.6% month-over-month) on the back of the US strikes. This is not to be corroborated and is dropped from this report.
- **Iran continues rejecting a direct-talks framing even as Trump claims progress.** Iran FM spokesman Baghaei, Jul 27: "We have no negotiations with the United States at present" — directly to the US (Qatar/Egypt/Oman/Pakistan) remains on the table, unaccepted; Iran separately rejected an Oman joint-Hormuz-management proposal on Jul 28, insisting on controlling its own lane.
- **Congress split on competing War Powers resolutions (Jul 23, carried forward, no new action since):** House passed a nonbinding one 214-208 (4 GOP defectors); the Senate's binding one 68-32 is still pending.
- ★ **The Pentagon casualty-count dispute (18 vs. 14) is confirmed stale, not a fresh Jul 30 event.** The DCAS toll briefly rose to 18 (Jul 23) then reverted to 14 (Jul 24) amid a credibly-sourced report that the US had killed 18 Iranian IRGC advisors. The War Powers clock. This is the same dispute already logged last cycle — one daily touch this week re-cited the Jul 24 CNBC article as if it were new; it is not.
- **Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed to normal commercial traffic** — ~10 transits/day versus a normal baseline near 88/day (IMF PortWatch), unchanged from prior cycles. IRGC, US, and others have all claimed responsibility for the closure.
- **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side.** The 60-day window to ~**Aug 16** remains intact and un-triggered.
- **Israel remains out of direct engagement** — no confirmed direct Israel-Iran exchange since June 7-8; the widened fronts (Iraq, Egypt) involve the US, Saudi Arabia, and unclaimed actors, not Israel.
- **The "Layla" tanker claim (Jul 23) remains unconfirmed** after a full week — AIS data dark, no primary confirmation found. Downgraded from "watch" to "discard pending new evidence."
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a ~**\$98,225 intraday low**, reclaimed \$107k+ within days, a fast V. The far larger 2026 war still hasn't crossed the threshold to spread to two new countries this week.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the **"buy-the-invasion" rebound**. Anchors: Russia–Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a **~\$34,300 intraday low**, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended **~+25-28%** fully recovered within a week.

The Aug 30-31 direct US-Iran exchange has now escalated sharply further: a ~50x-larger US strike wave, the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government tankers, and a four-country Iranian pillar had been building since Aug 25 (Oman's own government confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor). That corridor claim is still technically on the table, unretracted, but a fresh, much-larger dip-buy thesis is down at all right now. BTC traded at **\$76,581.44** on Sept 2, down from Sept 1's \$78,038.78 — a real, visible risk-off move that for once tracks the same direction as this pillar's own evidence. This is scoring evidence — this report scores the war's facts, not the market's reaction to them. The upside case is unchanged in shape: a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both sides actually would shift the prize from "temporary corridor" to "a full corridor reopens and the risk premium unwinds for real." That's now considerably further away than it was even yesterday, not closer.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **The cut may still be too small, even at 1/9/27/47/74.** Nearly 100 targets, the war's first direct tanker strikes, and a four-country simultaneous retaliation is a genuinely different order of magnitude from front-end windows (1mo, now at P=1, barely above the floor) understate just how close this now sits to the worst-case scenario this pillar has always flagged as the real tail risk, and that keeping the current incidents, is itself a mistake when the underlying event is this much larger.
- **Leaving it as a draft may itself be too cautious.** The independently-confirmed facts alone — CENTCOM's own ~100-target count, the first-ever tanker strikes, the four-country retaliation, and the fact that the US is justified in justifying this cut without leaning on the wedding-strike claim at all; a reader could argue this pillar is using the single-source caveat as an excuse to soften a call the non-disputed facts already suggest.
- **The cut may be too small.** This report explicitly pre-declared "a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" as the line that breaks the dip-buy thesis — and calibrated the actual cut to a line of standing, pre-committed warning line. A stricter reader could argue firing your own flip line warrants a materially larger cut than a routine tanker incident, precisely because the report itself says the war is escalating.
- **The cut may be too large.** One resumed-strike night after ~28-30 clean nights is, so far, a single interdiction event (stopping a mine-laying attempt) rather than evidence of a full campaign of escalation, but it's equally possible this is a contained, one-off enforcement action that doesn't repeat. If no further strikes follow in the next few days, this cut may prove to have moved faster than the market.
- **The Oman corridor confirmation (Aug 25) is not retracted.** Oman's own Foreign Ministry still has not walked back its Aug 25 joint statement — the first time both parties on the "deal" side of the structural fact, and a reader could argue the 1yr/3yr windows are being cut too by association with a fundamentally 1mo/3mo-scoped shock.
- **The Aug 24 sanctions package is arguably a bigger structural story than this week's kinetic exchange.** It was the first Iran sanctions action in this war to explicitly name digital assets as a category this pillar has never faced before, and one that doesn't fade if the current strike cycle cools.
- **No confirmed US casualty, still.** The single hardest-edged clause of this pillar's own flip line — a confirmed new US combat death — remains unfired even after this week's exchange; a reader could argue the strikes-resumed clause alone.
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on a handful of dip-and-recover events, all in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover, and a fresh direct strike exchange could trigger cuts of similar or larger size.
- **Two more restraint signals landed this cycle, logged honestly — a reader could argue they're under-weighted.** The BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) — signed by S. P. "maximum restraint" and voiced concern over attacks on civilian and nuclear infrastructure, and Trump's own account describes the Houthis privately signaling they don't want direct US involvement (substance), but this pillar logs every new strike within a day while diplomatic restraint signals like these get folded in as a line, not a re-rate — a stricter reader could argue that asymmetry itself.

The Triggers

dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-leveled August 22, 2026, refreshed August 29; **this pillar's own downside flip line FIRED August 30** (see the flip-line box below) — a resumption of direct escalation continued sharply Sept 1-2 — a materially larger strike wave and a four-country retaliation; the Sept 5 tanker strike is CENTCOM-CONFIRMED and revealed to be part of a direct IRGC missile attack on 2 US Navy warships yet executed; CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8, and Brent crosses \$100 intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24; the IRGC retaliates for that strike by hitting Jordan's Al Azraq air base Sept 9, and Houthi forces seize **clause has now fired** — the "sustained Brent close above \$100" clause, on a third consecutive session above \$100 including a close above \$107 on Sept 10. **By Sept 11-12, Houthi forces completed their sweep of Yemen's Red Sea** "closing in on" to actual island-level control, though it does not independently fire a fresh flip-line clause (top row). **As of the Sept 13 light daily touch, the first de-escalation datapoint in six weeks landed: Iran's foreign minister in Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 on Strait of Hormuz navigation, safe shipping routes and mine clearance — the first such gathering since the war began in February** (Iranian MFA statement, primary, plus 6+ **Bahrain's announced non-attendance, an Iranian official's statement that no deal is expected, the fact that the agenda concerns managing a strait Iran still controls, and continued fighting on Sept 13 (a fatal vessel)** **NOT fire the upside flip line, which requires a signed, US-accepted Hormuz reopening holding a full clean week. In the prior Sept 12 full weekly refresh, a third distinct Saudi oil-infrastructure strike landed — drone** Sept 11), sponsorship undetermined (Trump's "probably Iran" is a single hedged remark) — neither the widening clause (Iraq is existing theater) nor the US-casualty clause fires.

DATE	EVENT
FIRE d Sept 13 — PRIMARY (Oman News Agency statement) plus 5+ independent outlets (Arab News, Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News, Malay Mail)	The Salalah ministerial was POSTPONED, one day before it was to convene, with NO new date. ONA: the meeting is “postponed to a later date ... in order to create conditions conducive to a constructive dialogue.” Bahrain had explicitly ruled out attending; no GCC state had confirmed; the UAE had downgraded to minister of state. Iran’s MFA says Saudi Arabia requested the delay citing Yemen and calls that a pretext — <i>single-party-sourced to Iranian officials, reported not scored</i> . Separately, FM Araqchi said the Iran-Oman understanding “would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz” (Tehran Times/Mehr). Brent +2.8% past WTI \$102.34 — <i>market prices, reported not scored</i> .
Announced Fri Sept 11, reported Sept 11-12 — PRIMARY (Iranian MFA statement) plus 6+ independent outlets; SUPERSEDED — the meeting was postponed Sept 13, see the row above	First Iran-GCC ministerial meeting since the war began in February. The foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iraq convene in Salalah, Oman to discuss Strait of Hormuz navigation — safe/temporary commercial shipping routes, mine clearance and short-term management of the waterway, built on weeks of Oman-mediated Iran-Oman talks. Iranian MFA: the gathering aims “to promote better understanding among the countries of the region and help strengthen regional security” (Al Jazeera Sept 11, Dawn Sept 12, Arab News, Oman Observer, The Business Standard, Business Recorder, ARMENPRESS, SBS). Logged counterweights: Bahrain announced Sept 12 it will not attend; an Iranian official told JPost no signed deal is expected; Tehran is weighing a transit service-fee regime, i.e. the agenda is about managing a strait Iran still controls
Sept 13, reported same day (Al Jazeera live blog) — Iran’s attribution is Iran’s own and is NOT treated as established	A commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside the Strait of Hormuz, killing one and wounding four; an Iranian official blamed the “US terrorist era”. A Houthi projectile struck Jazan, Saudi Arabia, causing injuries and damaging a mosque. Houthi forces and Yemen’s internationally recognised government continued trading strikes over Bab al-Mandeb
Friday Sept 11 — a market price, reported NOT used to move P	Brent gave back 4.24% to ~\$104.26, the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 flip-line clause fired; wire coverage attributes it to the Houthi diplomacy plus the IEA’s demand-contraction forecast (TradingEconomics, Forbes)
Attack Sept 10, Saudi MFA statement/confirmation Sept 11 (primary) plus 6+ independent outlets — sponsorship UNDETERMINED (Iraqi-origin, no group claim)	Saudi Arabia’s East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — its primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route — hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory; Saudi MFA confirms pumping stations near Riyadh/Medina struck, injuries and material damage, will not retaliate for now at Baghdad’s request (Al Jazeera, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com). Iraq’s PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, closed the Shalamchah border crossing. Trump (Dublin): Iran “probably” responsible — single, hedged, unconfirmed, NOT treated as fact
Fired Sept 10-11, escalated to island seizure Sept 11, CONFIRMED via 6+ independent outlets — no strait closure yet	Houthi forces complete their sweep of Yemen’s entire Red Sea coastline (capturing Dhubab, Murad) and seize Mayyun (Perim) Island in the Bab al-Mandeb strait; fighting continues for Zuqar Island (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Saudi Crown Prince MBS’s request for direct US strikes on the Houthis was refused (intel/targeting support offered instead)
Sept 10 (UKMTO Warning 133-26, issued 1910 UTC), reported Sept 11 — CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus 3+ independent outlets	Four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire (UKMTO; Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborating). Logged, not used to move P (single-source, IRGC claim only): a separate IRGC claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance; US/CENTCOM confirmation
FIRE d Sept 10-11 — a flip-line clause, CONFIRMED via 4+ independent market sources	“Sustained Brent close above \$100” — Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 (above \$108 intraday), its highest since May 19; closed above \$102 for the first time since May; Brent still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, ~9% higher on the week (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500). Three consecutive sessions above \$100. <i>Correction:</i> the Sept 10 cycle logged ~\$101.25 as that Thursday’s level - intraday read, not the close
Fired Sept 9, fuller reporting landed Sept 10-11, CONFIRMED via 4 independent outlets (Reuters wire)	Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of shipping attacks by either side since the war began; at least one seafarer killed, one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill)
Fired Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM/Jordan’s own military statement plus multi-outlet reporting	IRGC retaliates for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan’s Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base — Jordan’s armed forces said 10 were intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan’s own military statement)
Fired Sept 10, CONFIRMED via 5+ independent outlets — chokepoint NOT yet closed	Iran-aligned Houthi forces seize the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a SECOND global shipping chokepoint distinct from Hormuz (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail)
Second straight session, logged Sept 10 — SUPERSEDED by the Sept 10-11 firing above	Brent crude trades near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session — above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 for the first time since May; the Sept 10 cycle logged ~\$101.25 as Thursday’s level, which proved to be an intraday read (Thursday closed above \$107)
Crossed intraday Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CNBC and ABC News — NOT a sustained close	Brent crude tops \$100/bbl intraday for the first time since July 24 , trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil-supply worries (CNBC, ABC News) “Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries,” ABC News)
Fired Sept 8, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM’s own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days (“US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship,” centcom.mil; NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org corroborating)
Announced Sept 6-7, on-record, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets — NOT yet executed	Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces Iran will declare a new “restricted zone” beginning at the US Navy’s blockade line and extending into the Persian Gulf “in the coming days,” with any vessel entering it placed on Iran’s sanctions list; he separately says an Iran-Oman corridor agreement will be signed “in the coming days” (Press TV, Tehran Times, Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, Newsbytes, WFLA, GlobalSecurity.org)
Fired Sept 5, CONFIRMED Sept 6 via CENTCOM’s own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5 — M/T Downy (disabled, Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (disabled, Jask), M/T (destroyed, Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (a carrier and a guided-missile destroyer), both

	which evaded; no US personnel harmed (centcom.mil; Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC corroborating)
Claimed Sept 6, single-source (IRGC) — NOT independently used to move P	Iran's IRGC claims further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels, and a strike on a US naval drone entering the Strait of Hormuz (Jazeera live blog, Euronews)
Fired Sept 3, CONFIRMED — repeat targets, widening clause did NOT fire	Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit and third night of launches followed
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED via 9 independent outlets	CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms sites, anti-ship cruise-missile/drone launchers — roughly 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak strike (Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI)
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED, novel	For the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms) under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy
Reported Sept 1-2, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact — NOT independently used to move P	A US strike on Kuhestak, Hormozgan reportedly hit a wedding party — Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead (incl. a 4-year-old), 60+ injured; CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it
Fired Sept 2, CONFIRMED via multi-source reporting — widening clause did NOT fire	IRGC coordinated ballistic-missile/drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait — most projectiles intercepted; no confirmed new US combat death
Fired Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting	A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week: the Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm northeast of Khasab, Oman (side, engine room, ballast tank), no casualties — follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25)
Claimed Aug 31, DISPUTED target / CONFIRMED incursion	Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; UAE MoD DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING it intercepted an Iranian drone over its territorial waters
Fired Aug 31, on-record — not a de-escalation signal	President Trump said on-record he is still weighing further strikes on Iran , calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo)
Fired Aug 30, CONFIRMED — FLIP LINE TRIGGERED	Resumption of direct US strikes on Iranian territory: CENTCOM struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Larak Island after observing prep to fire sea mines in the Strait — first US strike on Iran since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-night clean streak; corroborated by 20+ outlets plus on-record CENTCOM spokesperson Caitlin Hawkins
Fired Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED (Iran-claimed damage NOT independently confirmed)	IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases (King Hussein, Al-Azraq) — Jordan's military intercepted 8 missiles; Iran claims "no damage," unconfirmed by US/Jordan beyond interception; no confirmed US casualty
Fired Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package — home.treasury.gov sb0613/sb0614, OFAC recent-actions entry 20260824; ~60 entities/individuals/vessels designated under five EO 13902 sectoral determinations; FIRST TIME digital assets named a sanctionable sector, 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed; corroborated by state.gov, TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes, law-firm alerts; continued Aug 28 with a Bank Melli-Dubai designation
Fired Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor — fm.gov.om/en/53722; 7-mile joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), joint mine-clearing project, continuing talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum"; still explicitly "temporary," no fees disclosed; Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance
Fired Aug 24 & Aug 27, re-verified Aug 29	Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents: Aug 24, off Oman's coast, engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties (UKMTO); Aug 27, onboard, extinguished same-day, crew safe (UKMTO). Neither incident's attribution confirmed by any party.
Fired Aug 25, re-verified Aug 29 — real but NOT durable	Trump announced the Strait of Hormuz "has been demined" and declared a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines, backed by Space Force surveillance (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News, multiple corroborating) — the Aug 27 tanker incident above landed two days later, undercutting durability
Aug 28, CONFIRMED — re-verified Aug 29	CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing: Iranian sea mines cleared from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes; ~1,500 vessels transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 turned back, 3 disabled for evasion; no Iranian oil exports since blockade resumed (UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire)
Aug 28 IMO briefing, quasi-primary, corroborated by 4 outlets	Six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range
Week of Aug 17-23, reported Aug 21 & Aug 28 (USNI News/Lloyd's List)	First confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week, 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29→42) — still ~15% of the pre-war baseline
Claimed Aug 26, single-source, NOT USED — re-checked Aug 29	IRGC spokesman claims Iran and Oman agreed to share Hormuz revenue and delineate waters (Sepah News, Iranian state military source; via Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, Insurance Journal) — but Oman's own Foreign Ministry did NOT confirm it, the two countries' own joint statement described only an "interim framework" with no mention of fees, and the IRGC's own spokesman said the US is "obstructing this process"
Checked Aug 27 — GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker	28th consecutive night with no confirmed US/CENTCOM strike on Iran
Checked directly Aug 22-29 — no new event	No new confirmed US combat death. One initial-looking hit (Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton) was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the standing tally of not new
Fired Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative, but CORRECTED framing, toll RE-VERIFIED as a range	Fatal strike in the tanker-attack campaign: bulker Minoan Dignity struck, chief engineer killed

Fired Aug 17, held to Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	First Iranian vessel seizure since June 22: tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's post-MoU toll regime
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED reported, DISPUTED attribution, single-source; RECONCILED this cycle	The UAE reports Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory , one landing in territorial waters; Iran denies involvement, calls it a possible "false flag"
Announced Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, structural	The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran
Reported Aug 20, still unsigned as of Aug 22 draft2 — continuation, not yet resolved	The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned ; Iran claims coordinates agreed Aug 18, Oman has not confirmed
No new incident, checked Aug 19-22 — draft2 finding	Independent re-check for any new vessel strike, seizure, or Iran-related military incident, Aug 19-22
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed without a signed deal ; Iran says the US breached it first, Trump says "no time schedule" (softened Aug 19)
Fired Aug 17, logged Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, new target named	Trump threatened Oman ("we'd handle them very easily") if it "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait
Reported Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative	Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed to 3-5 weekend transits vs. 31 the prior weekend vs. ~110/day pre-war baseline (re-checked; see The Facts)
Fired Aug 18, logged Aug 20 — negative, isolated so far	A commercial vessel struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait , engine damage, one crew injury
Fired Aug 14-15, logged Aug 16 — continuation, now compounding	Three ADNOC tanker incidents (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, UAE/IRGC attribution, no direct Iranian claim
Reported Aug 13 — continuation, not escalation	Hormuz deal remains unsigned; both sides' compensation demands harden (Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, The Hill) — Brent eases ~\$87-90 as traffic stays low
Fired Aug 11, logged Aug 12 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi "double-tap" strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah (Bab al-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea) — 6 killed
Fired Aug 9, found Aug 11 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery (400,000 bpd) — no injuries, fire extinguished same-day
Reported Aug 8-9 — continuation, not escalation	Iranian FM Araqchi calls the Oman deal "very close" but adds a US-compensation demand ; UAE reports another ship hit; Oman condemns "repeated attacks"
Jul 31 - Aug 5 — CONFIRMED, negative, missed by daily checks	Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents (Gaslog Shanghai, Oman-side explosion, Minoan Pioneer, two Kumzar explosions) — IMO tally now 65 incidents since the war began
Fired Aug 7 — CONFIRMED, negative, new front	Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia , wounding 11 civilians — the conflict's first widening to a fourth state
Pending — the real trigger	Whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds through a full week without a tanker attack
Structural, ongoing	Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance plus the new Aug 7 Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact
By Dec 31, 2026	Final US–Iran nuclear deal signed — not fired, pending

The flip line, re-leveled — TRIGGERED Aug 30, and as of Sept 11 a SECOND distinct clause (sustained Brent close above \$100) has now ALSO fired: a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct (disputed) attribution, or a sustained Brent close above \$100 = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken. As of Aug 30, the "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause fired — CENTCOM struck Larak Island.

Brent close above \$100" clause has fired too — three consecutive sessions above \$100, including a close above \$107 on Sept 10, its highest since May 19. Two of the four clauses are now live; the remaining two are not. As of Sept 1-2, the strikes clause was already firing again at vastly greater scale — CENTCOM confirms nearly 100 targets struck (~50x Aug 30) plus the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government infrastructure. The "US combat death" clause remains unfired (no confirmed US casualty found as of this run); the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause did NOT fire despite Iran's Sept 2 retaliation hitting four countries simultaneously. This war, so "further new state with confirmed attribution" is not met; Brent rose ~5% (best session in 5 weeks) to ~\$95-96.6 but remains short of a sustained \$100 close. The evidence is nonetheless the largest sign yet that the war has moved beyond the initial phase.

UPDATE, Sept 6:

CENTCOM has now confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had withheld — a 3-tanker retaliation for an IRGC ballistic-missile attack on 2 US Navy warships — and Sept 6 brings further single-target strikes against Iranian oil facilities. No confirmed US casualty, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, Brent short of \$100 — the cut this cycle is modest (no window moved >2 points) and, unlike the Sept 2 cycle, is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority.

Upside flip: a signed Hormuz agreement the US actually accepts that holds past a full week without a new shipping attack, fatality, or seizure. Oman's own government confirmed a temporary corridor ATOU considerably further away, not closer. Watch next cycle for: whether Sept 6's IRGC claims are independently confirmed, whether either side's threatened "much larger"/"significantly larger" response actually materializes, or whether the US actually signs such an agreement.

Brent close above \$100 — any of which would independently fire a fresh flip-line clause and likely warrant a larger cut. UPDATE, Sept 8:

Iran's SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced intent to declare a "restrictive zone" around Persian Gulf oil tankers — a genuine new escalatory signal, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets, but explicitly not yet executed (no boundaries announced, no confirmed incident tied to it). This does not independently re-fire any of our criteria. Brent is still short of \$100 — the cut this cycle is modest (no window moved >1 point) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. UPDATE, Sept 9:

CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker second IRGC missile attack on a US Navy warship — a repeat pattern, not a widening to a new state, and no confirmed US casualty, so neither of those clauses fires. Brent crosses \$100/bbl intraday for the first time in the war, but an intraday cross is explicitly not a sustained close, so that clause does not fire either. None of the three unfired clauses independently re-fires this cycle — the cut is modest (no window moved >1 point) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority.

Brent close above \$100 (it is now closer to that threshold than at any prior point in this war), whether the restricted zone is actually declared and enforced, whether the Iran-Oman corridor deal is actually signed, a confirmed retaliates for the Sept 8 tanker strike by firing 20 missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq base — Jordan is a repeat target and both sides confirm no casualties, so neither clause fires. Houthi forces seize the Yemeni port of Mocha. The Strait of Hormuz closure is priced, and no strait closure has actually been confirmed, so this doesn't fire a clause either. Brent now trades above \$100 for a second straight session — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross and the close of the same day. CENTCOM sustains call. None of the three unfired clauses independently re-fires this cycle — the cut is modest (no window moved >1 point) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. UPDATE, Sept 12:

the Houthis have taken control of Mayyun (Perim) Island inside Bab al-Mandeb itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island (6+ independent outlets), and Brent has held a fifth straight session near/above \$104. Still, no strait CLOSURE or shipping attacks/theater, and no US casualty is confirmed, so that clause doesn't fire either — this is a severity escalation within the already-fired sustained-Brent and direct-strikes clauses, not a fresh clause. The cut is modest (no window moved >1 point) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority.

Next cycle for: whether the Houthis actually close or interdict shipping through Bab al-Mandeb (vs. merely holding its shores/islands), whether Zuqar Island's contested status resolves, a confirmed US combat death, a confirmed Saudi oil-infrastructure strike — the East-West Pipeline (Petroline), hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement Sept 11) — does not independently fire either the widening clause or the oil-infrastructure clause (both confirmed); sponsorship remains undetermined (Trump's single hedged "probably Iran" remark is not treated as fact). The cut is small (no window moved >1 point) and, because this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, is LEAST likely to fire.

categoryically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority. Watch next cycle for: whether responsibility for the pipeline strike is claimed or independently confirmed, whether the Houthis actually close or interdict shipping through Bab al-Mandeb, or whether there is a genuinely new state.

My Decision

COMMITTED — SEPTEMBER 15, 2026 (2026-09-15_draft) · LIGHT DAILY TOUCH · AUTO-STAMPED

P (2026-09-15_draft, COMMITTED — light daily touch, auto-stamped; HELD FLAT): 1 / 1 / 18 / 38 / 70 · Prior committed P (2026-09-14_draft, li
Impact: 8 (uniform) · This pillar's signals: 1mo -4.70 · 3mo -5.10 · 6mo -3.58 · 1yr -1.25 · 3yr +1.76 · Master (equal-weight) this cycle: 1mo -1
NUMBER: +0.45 equal-weight (Neutral) / +0.97 horizon-weighted (Mild Bull) — up from yesterday's +0.33 / +0.87 on the CLARITY re-rate, no

Sept 14 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-15_draft), this version — yesterday's up-move is retraced, because the meeting it rested on was called off: the Salalah ministerial never convened. C to create conditions conducive to a constructive dialogue," with **no replacement date** — corroborated across Arab News, the Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News and Malay Mail. Bahrain had ruled out attacking a Saudi request citing Yemen, which is **single-party-sourced and not used to move P**. FM Araqchi separately said the Iran-Oman understanding "would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz." **RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (1mo -2, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -1, 36mo flat). This is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was full, and Step 6 verification passed clean — so per the runbook's (auto-stamped)". **What would change my mind:** Oman naming a firm new date with Saudi and Bahraini attendance confirmed would re-fire the de-escalation read faster than it retraced.

Sept 13 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-13_draft), prior cycle — the first UPWARD re-rate on this pillar since August 6, now superseded by the postponement above: ONE sufficiency-clearing **ministry announced on Friday Sept 11 that the foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iraq will convene in Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 to discuss navigation through the Strait of Hormuz** short-term management of the waterway, building on weeks of Oman-mediated Iran-Oman talks. This is the first time high-level officials from Iran and the six GCC states have gathered in one place since the war, as an effort "to promote better understanding among the countries of the region and help strengthen shared regional security." Corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera Sept 11, Dawn Sept 12, etc.) comfortably clearing the sufficiency bar. **Four counterweights, all new and dated, are logged and sized in — they are why this is +2 points and not a reversal:** (1) Bahrain announced Sept 12 it will **NO** signed Hormuz deal is expected out of Monday's meeting — this is a convening, not an outcome; (3) the agenda concerns *managing* transit through a strait Iran still controls, with Tehran weighing a sea blockade; (4) the kinetic war did not pause — on Sept 13 a commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside Hormuz, killing one and wounding four (an Iranian official blamed the "US terrorist ene struck Jazan in Saudi Arabia causing injuries and damaging a mosque, and Houthi forces continued trading strikes with Yemen's internationally recognised government over Bab al-Mandeb (Al Jazeera live). Brent gave back 4.24% on Friday Sept 11 to ~\$104.26 — the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 flip-line clause fired — attributed by wire coverage to this diplomacy plus the already-announced clauses already fired (direct US strikes on Iran proper, Aug 30; sustained Brent close above \$100, Sept 10-11) remain fired and continue to hold — Brent is still above \$100. The upside clause is unambiguous and clean week. An announced meeting at which no deal is expected is not that. **P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo +2, 3mo +2, 6mo +2, 12mo +2, 36mo held at 70 (on the near windows where the meeting actually sits, and is sized symmetrically against the 1-to-2-point daily cuts this pillar has been taking all month. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was full, and Step 6 verification passed clean. Per the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority — widened Sept 2 so that it would not withhold — **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)".** The *direction* of the move does not change that test: the same rules that justified six weeks of downward

Sept 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2), prior version — still DRAFT, awaiting Alex's manual review: four parallel adversarial research passes ran across all four qualitative pillars (CLARITY Act, Tokenization, and Fed & Macro each held flat on independent re-check (see those reports). Iran War Risk found ONE sufficiency-clearing new fact beyond the morning baseline: **Saudi Arabia was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement/confirmation Sept 11)**, a new target distinct from the already-logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes. PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia was struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News, etc.) own PM ordering a probe, dismissing the Maysan operations commander, and closing the Shalamchah border crossing. **Attribution caveat:** no group has claimed responsibility, and the Saudi MFA statement called Iran "probably" responsible — a SINGLE, HEDGED, UNCONFIRMED remark, logged as exactly that, not as fact. **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater, not a new one); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no confirmed US military casualty this cycle). The sustained-Brent->\$100 clause continues to hold (~\$104.61 Sept 12, same as the previous account that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen (single-source as to substance, consistent with the already-logged MBS-refused-strikes counterweight), and the UAE urging "maximum restraint" — a mild, long-horizon diplomatic data point (1yr/3yr framing only). The Mayyun Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure was independently re-verified as still holding (Euronews, AP, etc.). **FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held, 1mo held at the near-floor 1. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, not a light daily touch, so stamp authority regardless of move size or how the sufficiency rule was applied. **This set is LEFT AS DRAFT: status draft, NOT stamped, flagged prominently for Alex's manual review.**

Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft), prior cycle: the load-bearing development is that Houthi forces, an Iran-aligned proxy, have moved from "closing in on" to actual island-level control. Having seized the port of Mocha Sept 10, Houthi forces captured Dhubab and Murad (the last government-held coastal towns) by Sept 11, giving them Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline, and separately seized al-Hudaydah, confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Saudi Crown Prince MBS's request for direct US strikes on the Houthis was refused, with intelligence suggesting they would not. Separately, UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 confirms two more vessels struck near Khasab, Oman Sept 10 (one afire); an IRGC claim of a Saildrone strike is single-source and not used to move P. Brent held near \$100 already fired, not a fresh trigger. Neither the widening clause (Yemen is existing theater) nor the US-casualty clause fires — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a new flip-line event. **1/2/18/38/70** — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 4→2, 6mo 20→18, 12mo 40→38, 36mo 71→70. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was full (WebSearch working, etc.) neither the size of a move nor the severity of the underlying news is by itself a reason to withhold the stamp. **This set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)".** CLARITY Act and Tokenization held flat on independent re-check, tenth cooler than consensus — see those reports.

Sept 11 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-11_draft), prior cycle: the load-bearing development is that this pillar's own **"sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause has FIRED**. Brent ended its highest in nearly four months, since May 19 — with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent), ~3% give-back. That is three consecutive sessions above \$100, two of them confirmed closes and one decisively so; the two prior cycles called this a near-miss and explicitly flagged it for watching, and the current cycle is as that Thursday's level — an intraday read, not the close. Second, fuller reporting landed on the Sept 9 shipping wave: Iran attacked 10 vessels near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest de-escalation since the RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does NOT fire; no further new state was struck, so the widening clause does not fire. The transits Sept 9 vs a Kpler 10-day average of 10-13/day. Logged as counterweight: Friday's give-back is attributed to Hormuz diplomacy and the IEA's 2.5 mb/d demand-contraction forecast. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo +2, 3mo +2, 6mo +2, 12mo +2, 36mo held at 70. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was full (WebSearch/WebFetch working, local quant refresh ran), and verification passed clean — and under the runbook's clause firing is by itself a reason to withhold the stamp. **This set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)".** CLARITY Act and Tokenization held flat on independent re-check, tenth cooler than consensus — see those reports.

Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft), prior cycle: two new dated facts since the Sept 9 baseline. (1) CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by attacking two US Navy warships; state 18 were intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera Sept 9, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, corroborating Jordan's own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target (struck Sept 8, Sept 9, Sept 10). CENTCOM/Jordan both confirm no casualties, so the confirmed-US-casualty clause also does not fire (US KIA count remains 18, unchanged since Sept 4 per GlobalSecurity's own tracker — a separate low-casualty event against CENTCOM's own no-casualties statement). (2) Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a SECOND gulf of Aden closure. Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), clearing the sufficiency bar. This is the same Houthi/Yemen actor and theater already priced (not a strike on a new actor — outlets describe Houthis as "closing in on" and "threatening" control, not as having executed a blockade — so it does not independently fire a flip-line clause either. Separately, Brent crude has now traded above \$100 for the first time since May; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Thursday Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's single-day intraday cross, but still short of a clean multi-session "sustained" call by this pillar's next cycle, but does not independently fire that clause. Net: a repeat-pattern regional strike plus a new-but-same-actor Yemen/Red Sea territorial escalation, both intensifying the trend already priced without a new actor. **23→22, 43→42;** 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room) and 36mo held flat at 72 (a repeat regional strike and a same-theater territorial shift do not move the multi-year thesis). No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip (Neutral→Neutral equal-weight, Mild Bull→Mild Bull horizon-weighted) — so per the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority this set is **AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)".**

Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft), prior cycle: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship," centcom.mil) confirms US Navy warships M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days. Corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (CENTCOM's own release — clears the sufficiency bar. CENTCOM confirms both Iranian missile attempts were evaded and no US personnel were harmed — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains untriggered. state clause does not fire either; this is a repeat pattern, not a fresh category of event. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday today (Sept 9) for the first time since July 24 — confirmed by CNBC and AP. trading ~\$100.44, +2.57% — a genuine escalation data point and the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause. announcement remains in the same not-yet-executed state as the Sept 8 baseline logged it — coverage today still describes boundaries as unspecified, so it is not re-scored a second time. This is a continuation of the trend already priced without a fresh flip-line event. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 7→6, 6mo 24→23, 12mo 44→43, 36mo 73→72.** No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)".**

Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft), prior cycle: Iran's SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record (Iranian state TV, carried by Press TV and Tehran Times), Sept 6-7, that Iran would "close the Persian Gulf" "in the coming days," with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list; he separately said an Iran-Oman corridor agreement would be signed "in the coming days." Corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iranian state media — clears the sufficiency bar. This is a genuine new escalatory signal but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed: Al Jazeera's own report announced, "and no zone had actually been declared as of this cycle's research cutoff. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire: DCAS US KIA remains 18 (unchanged since Sept 4), no widening of the US-casualty clause; the sustained-Brent->\$100 clause is short of \$100. GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) blockade count of 92 redirected / 3 disabled / 2 boarded (up from Day 190's 87/3/2 on Sept 3) is a continuation of the already-priced trend, not scored separately. **modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 8→7, 6mo 25→24, 12mo 45→44, 36mo held at 73.** No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)".**

Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05 draft2; this version: independently re-verified via WebSearch. The Sept 5 tanker report has firmed up considerably since the daily touch a few hours earlier: the nautical miles off Kharg Island per Tasnim (Iranian state media); separately, Iran International — a London-based Persian broadcaster editorially independent of and adversarial to Tehran — obtained video that a strike and warnings occurred. However, AP's own wire story on the incident is headlined "Iran accuses the US of targeting a tanker" — treating it as an accusation, not a confirmed fact — and US CentCom research pass (distinct from CENTCOM's on-the-record July 14-15 naval-blockade doctrine, under which the Curacao-flagged M/T Belma was disabled via Hellfire-into-smokestack after ignoring warnings — still needs either a primary confirmation (CENTCOM/Pentagon on the record) or independent-of-the-accusing-party corroboration of that specific fact; Iran International's video corroborates that warnings Iran's own narrative — so this is NOT used to move P this cycle, consistent with the daily touch's conclusion a few hours earlier. WATCH NEXT CYCLE for CENTCOM confirmation or denial. None of the pillar (standing count remains 18 per GlobalSecurity Day 189), no widening to a further new state (Sept 3's Kuwait/UAE strikes were both repeat cycles), and Brent held ~\$95-96/bbl Sept 3-4 — up roughly 9% w/ 1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy regardless of move size (here, zero) — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY A

P RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY: 1mo 7→1, 3mo 15→9, 6mo 32→27, 12mo 50→47, 36mo 75→74. Every window moved under 8 points, but this is the largest front-loaded cut since the Aug 30-31 flip-line (US casualty, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, Brent short of \$100), but the already-fired "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause is escalating sharply in scale, which is what's driving the move.

Why this was originally left as a draft Sept 2, pending manual review: (1) the core wedding-casualty fact — the emotional and political driver of that day's four-country retaliation — is single-narrative, was lower than for a cleanly multi-sourced primary event, and this pillar's own research chose not to self-approve a cut resting partly on it; (2) the jump in scale — nearly 100 targets and the war's first-ever escalation this pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedents didn't cleanly cover; (3) both sides were on-record threatening much larger responses ahead ("significantly larger" from Trump, "many times greater" from Iran) and the pillar's own research independently flipped the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band (Mild Bull → Neutral) versus the last stamped set — under the rules in force that day, this alone disqualified the set from delegation.

Historical note: the paragraph above was the Sept 2 cycle's original manual-review flag, superseded by the Sept 3 auto-stamp policy widening and, again, by this cycle's own auto-stamp. Left here for the audit to recompute.

*LIGHT DAILY touch, September 15, 2026 (score set **2026-09-15_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-14_draft committed baseline (1/1/18/38/70). **This pillar HELD FLAT.***

- Carried forward — what changed in the September 14 light daily touch (2026-09-14_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

*LIGHT DAILY touch, September 14, 2026 (score set **2026-09-14_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-13_draft committed baseline (3/3/19/39/70).*

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Carried forward — the September 13 light daily touch, for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 13, 2026 (score set 2026-09-13_draft, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12_draft2 full weekly refresh (still draft, awaiting Alex's manual review).

- ★ ★ **NEW — and for the first time since August 6, it cuts the other way: Iran's foreign ministry announced Friday Sept 11 that the foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iraq began navigation.** Agenda: safe and temporary commercial shipping routes, mine clearance, and short-term management of the waterway, built on weeks of Oman-mediated Iran-Oman talks. This began in February. PRIMARY: the Iranian MFA's own statement ("to promote better understanding among the countries of the region and help strengthen shared regional security"); corroborated by Observer, The Business Standard, Business Recorder, ARMENPRESS, SBS).
- **Counterweight 1 — incomplete participation:** Bahrain announced Sept 12 that it will not attend the Oman meeting.
- **Counterweight 2 — no outcome expected:** an Iranian official told the Jerusalem Post that no signed Hormuz deal is expected out of Monday's meeting. This is a convening, not a settlement.
- **Counterweight 3 — what is actually being negotiated:** the agenda concerns *managing* transit through a strait Iran still controls, with Tehran weighing a service-fee regime for transiting vessels.
- **Counterweight 4 — the fighting did not pause.** Sept 13: a commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside Hormuz, killing one and wounding four (an Iranian official blamed the attack; a projectile struck Jazan, Saudi Arabia, causing injuries and damaging a mosque; Houthis forces and Yemen's internationally recognised government continued trading strikes over Bab al-Mandeb).
- **Market corroboration, reported NOT scored:** Brent gave back 4.24% Friday Sept 11 to ~\$104.26 — the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 clause fired — attributed to a forecast. A market price, not the mover.
- **No flip-line clause fires in either direction.** The two fired downside clauses (direct US strikes on Iran proper, Aug 30; sustained Brent close above \$100, Sept 10-11) both remain fired and closed. A full clean week — an announced meeting with no deal expected is not that.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo/3mo/6mo/12mo +2 each, 36mo held flat at 70. Concentrated on the near windows where the move is most likely. **AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)"** — an ordinary light daily touch with full research capability, clean verification, and sourcing well above the baseline.

Previous entry — FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 12, 2026 (score set 2026-09-12_draft2, still draft) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline.

- ★ ★ **NEW — a third distinct Saudi oil-infrastructure strike this week: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline), the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass export route, hit by drone strikes** corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com); Iraq's PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, and ordered a probe.
- **Attribution caveat:** no group has claimed responsibility; Trump's Dublin remark that Iran is "probably" responsible is a single, hedged, unconfirmed statement, not treated as fact.
- **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq already an active theater since the Sept 1 Erbil strike); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (none confirmed).
- **Logged, not scored:** the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) urging "maximum restraint," and Trump's account of a private Houthi restraint signal on Yemen — both counterweighting the widening clause.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held flat. **This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh** (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size).

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — a second global oil chokepoint moves from "under threat" to under adversary-aligned control.** Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, captured Dhubab and Murad by Sept 11, giving them the ENTIRE Red Sea coastline, and separately seized Mayyun (Perim) Island inside the Bab al-Mandeb strait, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC). Sept 10 baseline's "closing in" characterization.
- **Logged, honest counterweight:** Saudi Crown Prince MBS twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused (intelligence/targeting support offered instead).
- ★ ★ **NEW — UKMTO Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire** (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborated).
- **Logged, not scored (single-source):** IRGC's own claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM confirmation found.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. Neither the widening clause nor the already-fired flip-line environment, sized moderately larger than the routine 1-point daily touches given the scale of the underlying news. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority,** the score is set.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — Houthi forces launched a significant ballistic-missile-and-drone attack directly on Saudi Arabian soil Sept 8, hitting Saudi Aramco energy facilities — including the 400,000-barrel-per-day Energy Ministry confirmed several energy facilities and utilities temporarily halted; Saudi authorities confirmed 73 wounded (NPR, NBC News, Bloomberg, The Times of Israel, US News, Al Jazeera).** Arabia is a repeat target — the widening clause does not fire, but this is materially more severe than prior Saudi-linked incidents.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude closes above \$100/bbl for a THIRD consecutive session, moving decisively to \$105.71-\$108** — the highest since May 19 (Reuters-linked wires, Bloomberg, Energy Intelligence). The strikes plus continuing US-Iran tanker exchanges — the closest this war has come to a sustained >\$100 close, still not formally called fired.
- ★ ★ **NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors votes 23-3-8 Sept 9 to refer Iran to the UN Security Council over nuclear non-proliferation breaches** — the first such referral in two decades (Malaysia Today, CDM Press). Iran's Azizi threatens on-record retaliation Sept 11, single-source, not used to move P.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, larger than the recent 1-point touches, to 1/3/19/38/69** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -3, 12mo -4, 36mo -3. The state, Brent's third session not yet a formally sustained close). No window moved more than 4 points, master call band unchanged everywhere — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority,** the score is set.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, retaliating for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike.** Jordan's armed forces confirmed (GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target — the widening clause does not fire; no casualties on either side — the US-casualty clause does not fire.
- ★ **Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait,** a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz (The Media Line). The actor/theater already priced; no strait closure actually confirmed.
- **Brent crude traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session** (above \$101 Sept 9, ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, but still short of a sustained close.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause index fired (not yet a sustained close). No window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority,** the score is set.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Khasab) over the preceding two days.** Corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 Iranian Oil Tankers, Evaded, no US personnel harmed).
- **Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24,** trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC, ABC News) — the closest that cycle has come to a sustained close.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority,** the score is set.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any vessel that enters.** Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iranian state media (Press TV, Tehran Times) — clears the sufficiency bar.
- **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer says boundaries have yet to be announced; no zone has actually been declared. A parallel claim of an imminent strike is also made.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause index fired (short of \$100). No window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority:** status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)"

- Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-05_draft2, committed by Alex), for continuity:

- Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 2 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-02_draft, committed), for continuity:*

- Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:*

- Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:*

- Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft, held P flat, left as draft, now superseded), for continuity:*

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- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76** — the confirmed sanctions escalation and the confirmed Oman corridor upgrade roughly offset; neither independently clears the sufficiency excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority).

Carried forward — the abandoned Aug 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28_draft), for audit continuity: that draft first logged the two Aug 24/27 tanker incidents, Trump's Aug 25 demining claim, and the IRGC revenue-sharing claim researched and re-verified all of it fresh (see above) rather than carry it forward on trust. Treated as not-delivered, same discipline as the Aug 17-21 gap.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23), for continuity: Background, for completeness: Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts were each researched but never delivered (2 of 6 reports touched) before stopping without finishing render/selfcheck/archive/commit; the Aug 22 morning catch-up treated all four as not-delivered and independently re-verified via four parallel primary-source research passes, then researched the pillar again and ran a second, dedicated adversarial pass.

- **Aug 17/18/20 drafts (never delivered):** held flat, then cut to 17/25/38/54/76, then cut further to 16/24/38/54/76 on the lapsed MoU window and the UAE missile claim (framed as a "novel es
- **Aug 21 (partially delivered, then abandoned):** a session began delivering the Aug 20 draft's numbers but updated only 2 of 6 reports and never ran render/selfcheck/archive/commit — tre
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — a fatal strike in the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign**, Aug 17-18: bulker Minoan Dignity's chief engineer killed, 7+ independent sources. That draft first (wrongly) — a toll this report had never surfaced before.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22**, the tanker Amara, boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17, still detained Aug 19. Confirmed accurate on adversarial re-c
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — CORRECTION: the UAE missile claim is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE** as prior drafts framed it; UAE was hit in April and at Fujairah May 4. The "novel es again this cycle.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — casualty toll re-verified as a range, not a point figure.** Second dedicated adversarial pass cross-checked Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (1 (19, but broader-Middle-East scoped, not clean Hormuz) — honest toll is a **15-19 range (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**. This softens the morning draft's "roughly the 18th" report.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — the UAE missile claim reconciles to one episode, not two.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing adversarial pass as a possible miss; confirmed on reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline.
- **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — no new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22** on independent re-checking; CENTCOM's blockade tally continues climbing incrementally (68 vessels redirected, vs 95/bbl (Aug 20-21), a second straight weekly gain, still under the \$100 flip line.
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes since Aug 1; sanctions remain mostly rhetoric** (one narrow OFAC-adjacent Hezbollah designation Aug 22, not the promised Iran-economy package); Iran sa
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 (Aug 22)** — +7.4% vs. the Aug 20 close of \$71,882.92, a further move against the direction of this pillar's own evidence — logged as an honesty check (The Claim),
- **Score decision (draft2):** versus the Aug 16 committed baseline: 1mo 20 → **14** · 3mo 28 → **22** · 6mo 41 → **38** · 12mo 56 → **54** · 36mo 77 → **76** — unchanged from the Aug 22 morning draft; H delegated daily auto-stamp authority); **COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026** after review. See My Decision for the full reasoning.

Sources

Retrieved & graded September 15, 2026, LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-15_draft; earlier sources below still stand for facts not re-checked this cycle) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official/primary sources first, then re Affairs' own announcement of the Sept 14 Iran-GCC Hormuz ministerial in Salalah, Oman; Al Jazeera, Dawn, Arab News, Oman Observer, The Business Standard, Business Recorder, ARMENPRESS and SBS corroborating; Bahrain's no vessel attack and the Jazan projectile; TradingEconomics/Forbes on Brent's Friday give-back (market price, not scored).

- **September 14 LIGHT DAILY touch (this cycle): Oman News Agency (ONA) — state news agency statement, Sunday Sept 13, 2026: the Salalah regional meeting is "postponed to a later date ... in order to cre** Albusaidi — post on X reaffirming Oman's commitment to regional dialogue (primary) · Arab News, "Oman says Hormuz talks with Iran, Gulf states postponed" (Sept 13) · The Washington Post, "Oman postpones regional of Hormuz postponed, Omani official says" (Sept 13) · Gulf News, "Oman postpones GCC-Iran meeting on Strait of Hormuz as oil prices rise on supply fears" (Sept 13-14; also the source for Iran's MFA spokesman attribut \$102.34, market prices) · Malay Mail, "Oman postpones Iran-Gulf talks on Strait of Hormuz" (Sept 14) · Tehran Times / Mehr News, "FM Araqchi: Oman understanding not enough to reopen Hormuz" (Sept 13 — Iranian st Eurasia Review and Sunday Guardian (Sept 14) — corroborating the Araqchi statement · Checked and excluded as stale: Seatrade Maritime, Argus Media, Times of Israel and Gulf News reporting on drone strikes at Salalah
- **September 13 LIGHT DAILY touch (prior cycle):** Iranian Ministry of Foreign Affairs — announcement (Friday Sept 11) that Iran will meet the GCC foreign ministers and Iraq in Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 to discu of the region and help strengthen shared regional security" (primary) · Al Jazeera, "Iran says will discuss Strait of Hormuz with Gulf states on Monday," Sept 11 · Dawn, "Tehran agrees to engage Gulf states over Hormuz f Business Standard · Business Recorder · ARMENPRESS · SBS — 6+ independent corroboration of the meeting, its date, its ministerial level, and its agenda (safe/temporary shipping routes, mine clearance, short-term man counterweight · Jerusalem Post, "No signed Hormuz deal expected yet from Oman, Gulf States meeting on Monday, Iranian official says" — logged counterweight · Al Jazeera live blog, Sept 13 — commercial vessel attack established), Houthis projectile on Jazan, continued Bab al-Mandeb fighting · TradingEconomics and Forbes — Brent's 4.24% Friday Sept 11 give-back to ~\$104.26, reported as a market price and explicitly not used to mo
- **September 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (prior cycle):** Saudi Arabia's Ministry of Foreign Affairs — official statement confirming drone strikes on East-West Pipeline (Petroline) pumping stations near Riyadh/Medina, Sept 1 reporting, satellite imagery of fire/smoke at the pumping stations near Al Mesba'ah and Al Dhekra · Iraqi PM's office (via corroborating outlets) — probe of the Maysan operations command, commander dismissed, Shal (single, hedged, unconfirmed); Houthis privately signaled no desire for direct US involvement in Yemen (single source as to substance) · BRICS New Delhi summit — joint declaration, Sept 12, signed by all members plus Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge — re-verification that the Mayyun (Perim) Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure still holds · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$104.61 Sept 12, unchanged from the morning baseline.
- **September 12 light daily catch-up (prior, this morning):** Al Jazeera ("Can the Houthis close the Red Sea after seizing the Yemen coast?," Sept 11) — Houthi capture of the entire Red Sea coastline · NBC News, CNBC, N Mayyun (Perim) Island, fighting continuing for Zuqar Island; Saudi Crown Prince MBS's request for US strikes on the Houthis refused · UKMTO Warning 133-26 (1910 UTC Sept 10, official) — four projectiles struck two ves the Khasab incident · TradingEconomics, psuconnect.in — Brent settled ~\$104.61 Sept 12, a fifth consecutive session near/above \$100 · GlobalSecurity.org, Iran War 2026 Day 196 (Sept 11) — IRGC claim of a Saildrone st 13) vs. \$77,289.66 (Sept 12) vs. \$77,063.25 (Sept 11) vs. \$77,993.99 (Sept 10).
- **September 11 light daily catch-up:** Rigzone (Bloomberg wire, Sept 10) — Brent ended Thursday up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, highest in nearly four months; WTI closed above \$102, higher on the week; cites Hormuz diplomacy and the IEA's 2.5 mb/d 2026 demand-contraction forecast as the counterweight · Vantage Markets, NAI500 (Sept 10) — corroborating Brent above \$100-102 on Hormuz strik Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), largest declared wave of shipping attacks of the war; at least one seafarer killed, one missing · GlobalSecurity.org, Iran War 2026 Day 195 (Sept 10) — direct fetch returned HTTP used alone to move P).
- **September 10 light daily catch-up:** Al Jazeera (Sept 9), MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org (Iran War 2026 Day 194) — corroborating reporting on Jordan's own military statement confirming the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail — corroborating reporting on the Houthi seizure of the Yemeni port of Mocha, Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-M Brent ~\$101.25 Thursday Sept 10 · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged; a separate low-quality aggregator's claim of a fresh KIA figure checked and rejected as unco \$78,435.62 (Sept 8).
- **September 9 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship" (Sept 8, primary source): M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T H GlobalSecurity.org — corroborating reporting on the same CENTCOM statement and the two IRGC missile attempts on a US Navy warship, both evaded · CNBC — "Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes sto casualty records (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7).
- **September 8 light daily catch-up:** Press TV, Tehran Times (Iranian state media) — Mohsen Rezaei's (SNSC secretary) on-record statement, Sept 6-7, announcing intent to declare a "restricted zone" from the US Navy's L "in the coming days" · Al Jazeera ("Can Iran enforce a restricted zone in the Strait of Hormuz?," Sept 7 explainer, noting boundaries not yet announced), The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency (aa.com.tr), Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexts War 2026 Day 192 update (Sept 7): blockade count 92 vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded (vs. Day 190's 87/3/2, Sept 3) · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7) vs. \$80,338.98 (Sept 6).
- **September 6 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "CENTCOM Destroys 3 IRGC Oil Tankers After Iran Targets 2 U.S. Navy Warships" (Sept 5, primary source) · Al Arabiya English, Jerusalem statement, ship names (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kyo) and the IRGC ballistic-missile attack on 2 US Navy warships · Al Jazeera live blog ("Iran war live: IRGC claims attacks on 3 oil tankers and 3 US-linked ships," Sep not US-confirmed, NOT used to move P · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · TradingEconomics / multiple market-desk reports — Brent ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 clo \$79,929.30 (Sept 6) vs. \$79,646.11 (Sept 5).
- **September 3-5 re-check:** GlobalSecurity — Iran War 2026 Day 188-189 updates (Sept 3-4): Iran's second retaliatory wave hit Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE), both repeat targets; a US official confir at 18 · Reuters (via Spokesman-Review, Nukta, Tribune, TBS News, unn.ua) — four independent weapons experts' forensic analysis of images/video verified by Reuters, concluding the Sept 1 Kuhestak wedding strike was comment, Sept 4 · Times of Israel liveblog, Euronews, Newswire.lk — Sept 5 Iranian-media-only (Fars) report of a tanker strike near Kharg Island, unconfirmed by CENTCOM or any independent source · Critical Threats/IS on Israel; IDF took the ridge Sept 3, no such attack confirmed as of this run.
- **September 2 light daily catch-up — CENTCOM-confirmed strikes plus multi-source reporting on the retaliation:** Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI — corroborating reporting on the CENTCOM-confirmed US strik ship cruise-missile/drone launchers) and the first-ever direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy · Al Jazeera, CBS News, Yahoo, UPI — reporting on the Kuhestak Hawkins told CBS News the US has neither confirmed nor denied it — flagged single-narrative-sourced at the core fact level, per this report's own sufficiency rule) · Al Jazeera, Yahoo, CBS News, RFE/RL — corroborating and the absence of a confirmed new US combat death · CNBC — Trump's "significantly larger response" threat and an unnamed senior Iranian military source's "many times greater" quote · multiple market-desk reports \$76,581.44 (Sept 2) vs. \$78,038.78 (Sept 1).

- September 1 light daily catch-up — UKMTO log plus multi-source reporting:** UKMTO — Senegal Prosperity incident log, Aug 31 (VLCC struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm NE of Khasab, Oman; port side, en route to Seatrade Maritime, Iran International — corroborating reporting on the Al Minhad Air Base drone-strike claim (Iran's army) and the UAE Ministry of Defense's on-record denial of the target claim plus confirmation of an Iranian strike on the 31 remarks that he is still weighing further strikes on Iran ("a relatively little war for us") · multiple market-desk reports (e.g. Bloomberg's Sept 1 oil roundup) — Brent ~+2% Tuesday Sept 1 on fresh-clash fears · Bitstamp
- August 31 light daily catch-up — on-record statement plus multi-source reporting:** CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins (on the record, via Bloomberg/CNBC/NBC/Newsweek) — confirms the Aug 30 strike on the USS *Norman Macdonald* — "Iran War: US Strikes Rocket Launchers Near Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 30) · CNBC — "U.S. strikes Iranian rocket launchers near Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 30) · NBC News — "U.S. forces strike Iranian rocket launchers near Strait of Hormuz" · The Epoch Times, Daily Caller, OANN, FXStreet, Time News, WLT Report (Aug 30, corroborating) · Korea Times, India TV News, RFE/RL — Iran's IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on King Fahd oil terminal, 11 missiles intercepted · Al Jazeera — "Iran targets Jordan after first US attack in a month" (Aug 31) · Reuters/CNBC — renewed exchange weighing on Asian equities and US futures, oil higher · Bitstamp — BTC \$78,447.16 (Aug 31)
- August 29 full weekly refresh — direct primary-source adversarial fetches:** home.treasury.gov — press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic Day") and sb0614 ("Treasury Announces Sanctions Against Iranian Regime") · TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes (crypto-intelligence corroboration of the 30 BTC/ETH/TRON addresses listed, first-ever digital-assets sectoral designation) · law-firm trade-compliance client alerts (Aug 24-25) · fm.gov (US State Dept) · US State Dept (US State Dept) · Iranian state media (Aug 26) — Iran says the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance.
- August 29 full weekly refresh — reporting and data:** UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire (Aug 28) — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record mine-clearing/blockade briefing (Aug 28) · USNI News (Aug 21 & Aug 28), citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — first confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick, +30%+ week-over-week (114 vs. 87 transits, week of Aug 17-23) · Reuters (via Yahoo Finance) — UKMTO-sourced reporting (via UPI, France24) — Aug 24 tanker incident off Oman · UKMTO-sourced reporting (via OANN) — Aug 27 tanker fire · Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, Insurance Journal, Daily Sabah (Aug 27) — Oman's Foreign Ministry · TradingEconomics, various (Aug 25-28) — Brent ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28), second straight weekly decline · GlobalSecurity.org Day-181 tracker (checked directly) — Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton confirmed killed Jul 18-19, already in the standing total, not a new Aug 22-29 death · Bitstamp — BTC \$77,666.16 (Aug 29 close) vs. \$77,266.84 (Aug 22).
- August 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28 draft) — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; treated as abandoned/superseded, findings independently re-verified fresh above:** UKMTO-sourced reporting (via OANN) — Aug 27 tanker fire, extinguished, crew safe, "second attack this week" · Reuters (via Yahoo, France24, Axios, US News, Investing.com) — Trump's Aug 25 Strait-of-Hormuz tweet (Aug 26) — IRGC spokesman's Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, explicitly checked against and NOT confirmed by Oman's Foreign Ministry; the two countries' own joint statement describes only an "interim framework" · TradingEconomics
- August 22 draft2 — second dedicated adversarial-verification pass (same-day full weekly refresh, independent of the morning fact-check below):** Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox — cumulative deaths across 68 incidents · Highlighted Incidents" page (imo.org, fetched directly) — 19 seafarer fatalities across 68 incidents as of Aug 21, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly (may include the separate Aug 12 Bab al-Mandeb attack) · specific trackers), not a flat "18th death"; this softens the morning draft's framing throughout this report · Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday (all Aug 19) — UAE missile-attack and trade-embargo (Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline (CBS/CNN/Al Jazeera) · independent re-check for Aug 19-22 vessel strikes/seizures/incidents — none found beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline · TradingEconomics, Bloomberg (Aug 22)
- August 22 morning draft — adversarial fact-check (dedicated, independent of the research pass below):** Riviera, UN News, and Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" tracker — REFUTES this report's own initial framing of the 18th seafarer death since the campaign began late Feb 2026, UN News separately reports three seafarers killed in a June 2026 Hormuz strike, cumulative toll 12-17 deaths across ~65 attacks per multiple outlets · Bloomberg, Gulf News, The National, and UAE's own mofa.gov.ae — CONFIRMS the UAE-attack-history correction: a large Iran-attributed missile/drone barrage hit UAE Apr 1-8 (ceasefire Apr 8) and again at Fujairah Petrochemicals (Aug 22) · "novel escalation vector" framing carried since Aug 20.
- August 20-22 verification (four parallel primary-source research passes):** UKMTO, Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety4Sea, Splash247 (Aug 17-18) — bulkier Minoan Dignity struck, 11 crew injured, 11 wounded, OIC statement (Aug 7) — tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's toll regime, still detained Aug 19 · GlobalSecurity.org Day-175 tracker — no new US/CENTCOM strike sanctions package promised, pushed to "early next week"; narrower Aug 22 OFAC-adjacent Hezbollah-network designation confirmed as the only concrete action found · TradingEconomics, Vantage, Fortune (Aug 21) — Bitstamp — BTC \$77,266.84 (Aug 22 close, this cycle) vs. \$71,882.92 (Aug 20).
- August 18-20 verification:** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (all Aug 18) — UAE reports two Iranian ballistic missiles fired at its territory, one landing in territorial waters; Iran's foreign ministry denies involvement, calls it a possible financial dealings with Iran · UK Maritime Trade Operations (Aug 18) — commercial vessel struck by unknown projectile in the Strait, engine damage, one crew injury · CBS and CNN (Aug 19) — Trump threatens "the most severe" sanctions if Iran does not return to negotiations at some point... situation is so good" · TradingEconomics / Bloomberg (Aug 19) — Brent ~\$92/bbl · *Financial Times*, citing unnamed Iranian official · Single-source, uncorroborated by any second outlet this cycle; logged as a watch item, explicitly NOT used to move any P · Bitstamp — BTC \$71,882.92 (Aug 20 close) vs. \$64,285.10 (Aug 18 close).
- August 17-18 draft sources (never delivered as a report; independently re-verified this cycle against the above and found accurate):** CBS News — live desk, "Trump threatens to bomb Oman with Iran war stuck in the Strait" · Oman threat, Strait traffic 3-5 weekend transits vs. 31 prior weekend; pre-war baseline re-checked this cycle to ~110/day, not the ~130/day originally carried; Brent \$90.87) · CNN — "Deadline to reach US-Iran deal expires" · TradingEconomics — Brent \$90.97 (Aug 18).
- August 16 light daily check:** Al Jazeera — "UAE accuses Iran of attacks on two ADNOC vessels in Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 14) · CBS News — live desk, third ADNOC vessel hit Aug 15 (UKMTO), Vance remarks on energy-policy (Aug 15) — confirms the interim arrangement is still advancing, not collapsed, despite continued shipping attacks.
- August 14 light daily check:** US News — "Iran Says Deal on Strait of Hormuz Is Close but Not Enough to Open the Waterway" · NBC News — "Iran sets out steep demands for reopening Hormuz despite hopes Oman deal is near" · The Hill — "Iran's steep demands for US over Strait of Hormuz threaten to derail reopening" · Bloomberg — "Oil Holds Drop as Hormuz Deal Elusive While Ship Attacks Persist" (Aug 13) — a day shows day 166 of Strait closure.
- August 13 light daily check:** CNN — Hormuz agreement analysis, re-checked · NPR — Iran-Oman agreement terms, re-checked · Al Jazeera — "Iran deliberates Hormuz arrangement amid uncertain prospects with US" · Hormuz coverage archives, re-checked, no signing found as of Aug 13.
- August 11 light daily check:** NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba — six independent outlets corroborating the Aug 9 Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery, Saudi energy ministry statement on agreement coverage re-checked — no signing found as of Aug 11.
- August 10 light daily check:** GlobalSecurity.org — day-by-day Iran war tracker, re-checked, no new entry since Aug 5 · Euronews and Al Jazeera — Hormuz coverage archives, re-checked, no new dated item · Wikipedia — Hormuz coverage beyond these.
- August 9 light daily check:** Reuters — "Iran says deal on Strait of Hormuz is close but not enough to open the waterway," wire-distributed via Investing.com, US News, Jakarta Post, Japan Times, Haaretz, and Rappler (Aug 9) · condemnation of "repeated attacks" all trace to this single Reuters wire story.
- August 8 full-weekly additions:** Bloomberg / UANI — Hormuz incident tracking, 65 cumulative incidents (Jul 31 - Aug 5) · globalsecurity.org — Gaslog Shanghai and Minoan Pioneer incident detail · CNN — "Iranian-backed strike, 11 wounded, OIC statement (Aug 7) · wire coverage of the Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact (Aug 7) · Fortune — "Iran says agreement on Hormuz shipping reached with Oman" (Aug 7) and "Iran says agreement with Oman for Strait of Hormuz prohibits U.S. and Israeli vessels" (Aug 7) · Al Jazeera — "Iran, Oman, US 'close' to Hormuz deal: What do they all want?" (Aug 5) · Bloomberg — "Iran says deal on Strait of Hormuz is close but not enough to open the waterway" (Aug 5) · one-sided fee/ban terms (Aug 6).
- August 7 additions:** Iranian FM spokesman Baghaei (via globalsecurity.org/IRNA relay) — joint statement "in final stage," under review pending no third-party obstruction · Pravda USA (AP-sourced wire relay) — "Shipping industry officials (Aug 7) · CNN live updates — continuing Iran/Oman/US Hormuz coverage, Iran's IRGC commander reiterates nuclear-development position (Aug 6-7) · ABC News live updates — Trump comments on US munitions stockpile (Aug 7)
- August 6 additions:** IRNA (via Bloomberg/Military.com relay) — Deputy FM Gharibabadi's "understanding in principle" statement · Bloomberg — "Iran Says Deal With Oman on Strait of Hormuz Agreed in Principle" (Aug 6) — live updates, Iran/Oman deal getting close · Al Jazeera — "Iran, Oman, US 'close' to Hormuz deal: what do they all want?" (Aug 5) and "Hormuz deal 'close': what's the latest on each side's positions?" (Aug 6) · Euronews — "Iran says deal on Strait of Hormuz is close but not enough to open the waterway" (Aug 6) · Hormuz—and shipowners are outraged by its plan to charge fees" (Aug 6), fee figures (5-7% Iran, ~3% Oman, 0% US) · Jerusalem Post — "Proposed Hormuz passage deal not feasible for shipping industry, sources say" (Aug 6) · DOL — jobless claims 199K week ended Aug 1, prior revised to 198K (Aug 6).
- August 1-5 additions (prior week's catch-up):** globalsecurity.org — Iran War day-by-day tracker (Aug 1, Aug 4, Aug 5 entries) · Bloomberg — Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) struck in the Strait (Aug 1-2) · UKMTO — "Iranian-backed strike, 11 wounded, OIC statement (Aug 7) · National, DefenseMirror, Tribune — Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance, 14 members/43 nations (Aug 2) · NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN — Trump cancels US military presence in the Strait (Aug 4) · Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, Al-Quds — first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal (Aug 5) · CNN — live coverage, Gulf official cites 50-50 odds of deal (Aug 5)
- July 30 additions (prior full weekly refresh):** Al Jazeera — Iran's IRGC strikes US base in Jordan (Jul 28-29), corroborated by CNN, Axios, RT, Jerusalem Post · Al Jazeera — US-Saudi joint strikes on Iraq, 20 killed, corroborated by CNBC and Times of Israel · CNN — "US renews strikes on Iran as widening war pulls in more countries" (Jul 30) · Fortune — Brent ~\$92-93 (Jul 30) · CNN — Iran FM Baghaei denies direct US talks (Jul 27).
- July 11-13 additions (prior full weekly refresh — the escalation the light touches missed):** CENTCOM press releases — 3rd strike round (~140 targets, Jul 11) and 4th strike round (dozens more, first sea-launched attack dropped, Jul 12) · Windward, Oman strike coverage · Bloomberg (Jul 12) · NPR (Jul 11) · Washington Times (Jul 12) · The National (Jul 13) · Euronews (Jul 13) · Republic World and Peninsula Qatar (Jul 12) — Oman formal protest, ambassador's proposal · Business Recorder and RTE (Jul 13) — Iran FM spokesman Esmail Baghaei on continuing mediator talks · Middle East Eye and TASS — GFS Galaxy attack and rescue (Jul 11) · gCaptain — 3rd strike round detail · claim) · CryptoTimes, CoinDesk, Bitcoin.com, and Benzinga (Jul 13) — BTC weekend pullback to news-reported ~\$62,000-63,000 intraday range, mixed FOMC/CPI-vs-Iran attribution, first weekly BTC ETF inflow in nine weeks (Jul 13)
- July 11 additions (prior update):** CNN live — Araghchi in Oman on Hormuz, Trump MoU "over" + decimate threat, expected Iranian safe-passage statement (Jul 11) · CNBC — Brent context, UAE record production (refined) (Jul 11)
- The escalation (official statements via wire reporting):** NPR — second-night US strikes (July 9) · Bloomberg — attacks traded for second day (July 9) · CENTCOM release — second strike round (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · Bushehr/Chabahar/Iranshahr strikes, Kuwait intercepts (July 9) · The National — Iran attacks on Gulf states & Jordan (July 9) · RFE/RL — Hormuz/Jordan (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · NPR — Hormuz tanker attacks (July 9) — Trump "ceasefire over" quotes (July 8).
- Diplomacy:** Al Jazeera — talks status, no formal MoU withdrawal, Khamenei burial (July 10) · Al Jazeera — mediators urge MoU compliance (July 9) · CNN live — Trump on talks / "Cease Fire is OVER", Qatari team to Tehran (July 10) · source relay, unconfirmed) · Times of Israel liveblog — Israel-join-strikes report (July 10; single-source, unconfirmed) · Al Jazeera — Doha outcomes (July 2).
- The oil waiver:** CBS — GL X1 waiver rescission (July 7) · Axios — waiver revocation (July 7) · The Hill — sanctions detail (July 7).
- The prices:** Fortune — Brent ~\$76.00-76.80 (July 10) · Kitco/Reuters — oil fell as markets weigh strikes (July 9) · Sunday Guardian — Brent ~\$76 / WTI ~\$72 (July 10; weaker source) · CNBC — Brent \$78.02 / WTI \$73.52 (July 10) · "severe" advisory · LMA — insurance availability vs safety concerns · (Hormuz traffic magnitude conflicts across outlets — ~50% of pre-war vs ~92% drop — transponders off; pre-attack throughput figures are from the unconfirmed) · ~\$64K on chips/yen, not Iran (July 10) · Fortune — BTC ~\$61.7K (July 6, pre-escalation) · CoinDesk — ~\$450M liquidations (July 8).
- The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** Blockchain.News — invasion odds 11.5% → 14.5% (~July 8 print) · Blockchain.News — Hormuz-normal-by-July odds collapse to 4.5% (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · Direct Polymarket — only — inconsistent snapshots ~14.5% (Jul 8) → ~15.5% (~Jul 10) → ~17% (most recent), inconsistency itself flagged. "MoU withdrawal by Jul 31" reads (~5-7%, dated ~Jul 3-5) and "final deal by Dec 31" (35.5% last verified)